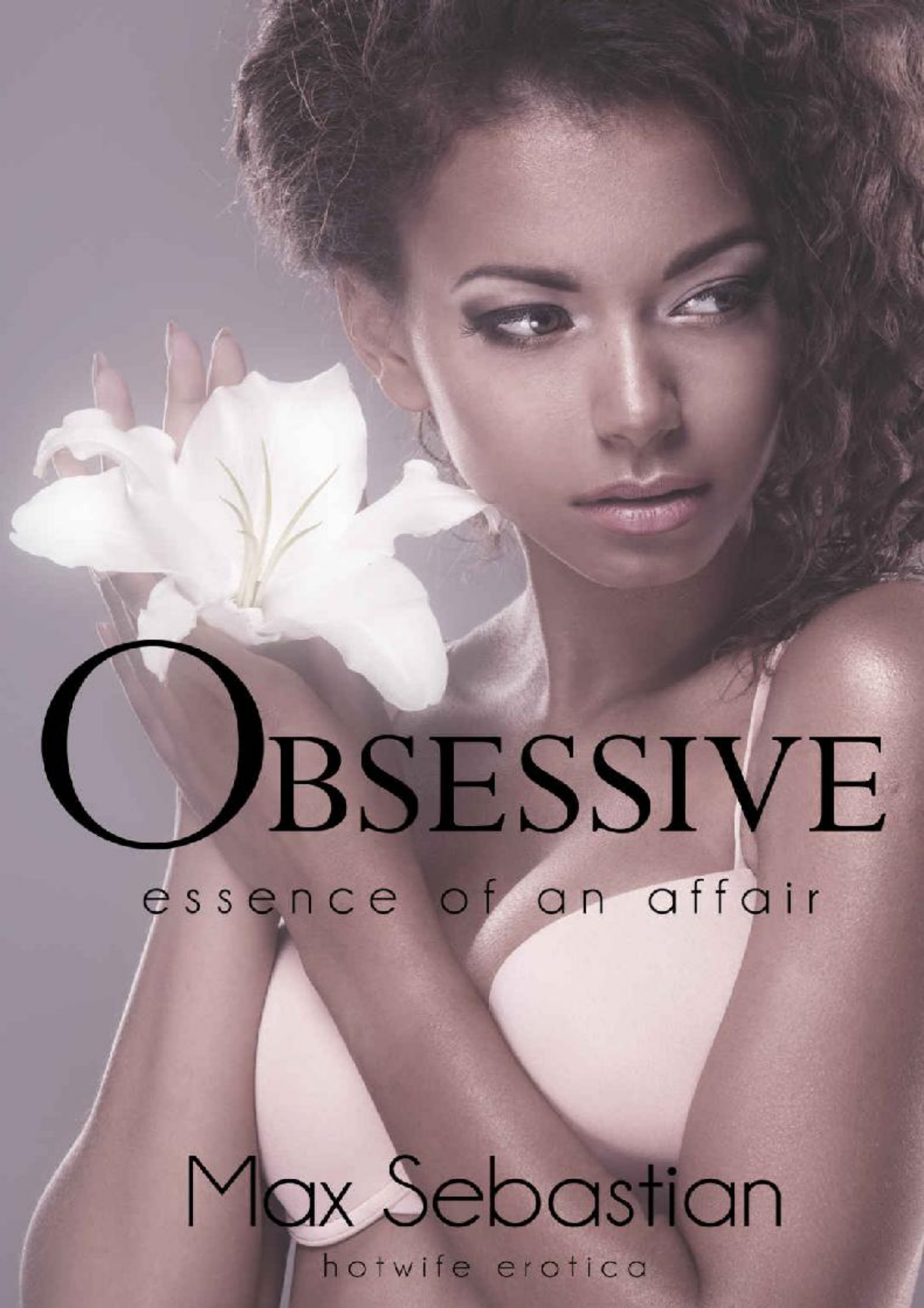


A woman with dark, curly hair is shown from the chest up, looking directly at the camera with a slight, enigmatic smile. She is holding a large, white lily flower in her right hand, which is positioned near her face. She is wearing a light-colored, possibly white, strapless top. The background is a soft, out-of-focus grey.

OBSESSIVE

essence of an affair

Max Sebastian

hotwife erotica

OBSESSIVE

ESSENCE OF AN AFFAIR

MAX SEBASTIAN

MaxSebastian.net

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THE ARRANGEMENT

'I think my wife is considering having an affair,' said Jens. His new therapist didn't seem to react at all, visibly.

After a long moment, the man asked, 'And how does that make you feel, Mr Nielsen?'

For a long moment, he just stared out of the window at the view across the choppy waters of the Peblinge Sø toward the pretty houses in the Nørrebro district of Copenhagen. He scratched at stubble on his jawline that was so short it wasn't even properly visible yet, and yet bothered him nevertheless. His hands were still cold from being recently washed.

Jens sighed. 'It's never happened before.'

'You say you 'think' she's considering having an affair. Have you talked to her about it?'

'No,' he smiled. 'That was the deal. She knew when she married me that I couldn't... you know...'

'You couldn't, or you *wouldn't*?'

'It's the same thing, isn't it?'

'I wouldn't say so. Some people with a *physical* disability can't, but...'

The therapist left the rest of his sentence unsaid, but it still irritated Jens immensely. The guy didn't have to say the words, there was just that look in his eyes, the one that said you're probably making it all up, just to get attention. Jens hated breaking in a new therapist, but sometimes it had to be done. You moved to a new city, or your therapist decided to retire to some seaside shack in Esbjerg, and there was no alternative. Wasn't like your shrink would take a three-hour drive just to keep up with a certain patient.

'So you have a special arrangement in your marriage? Is that it? Would you tell me about it?'

He had to take the new guy through it all, step by step. Explaining everything like he was talking to a child, from the very beginning. *Chapter One, I am born. I get too close to another human being--or an animal, or an unclean surface--and I start seeing millions and millions of teeming, squirming, wriggling bacteria that will make me sick if I get anywhere near.*

'When we met,' Jens said, trying to straighten the disposable tissue paper covering the leather couch on which he was sitting, 'We were... Neither of us could go anywhere near other people.'

'Your wife...' The therapist rustled through his papers to find details on Jens and his marital status. 'Effie. That's short for... Elizabeth? Euphemia?'

'Effia. It's an African name--her mother is originally from Ghana. Father is Danish, from Lyngby, so...'

'And she is like you? Does she also have--'

Jens shook his head, 'Oh no, she's not like me. Hers is... post-traumatic. She was... attacked. A long time ago, in college.'

'A stranger, or somebody she knew?'

'It was after a party. Some guy. It left her--'

The old man nodded. He didn't have to tell a therapist what that kind of experience might do to a young woman like Effie.

Jens remembered how she had looked when she had first joined the support circle at the Frihavnskirken community center. She'd worn a hooded top, the hood up almost all the time. Protective. She hadn't looked at anyone, certainly hadn't spoken to anyone, or the group. She kept to herself in coffee breaks. She and Jens had been the only ones in the group who never spoke in the circle of trust--the group leader did not force anyone to contribute, but always made it clear how much better members might feel to talk.

Effie had made incredible progress since then; Jens much less.

'You met her at your support group?'

Jens nodded.

It had taken six months before she would even engage with the group. After that, he'd seen her listening intently to the others, paying attention to their stories, to the details of difficulties out in the real world, tales of progress being made. After a year, she began to open up about her experience, about the man who had taken advantage of her, about the terror she had experienced, the pain.

Even early on, he'd been able to tell she was curious about him, about why he wouldn't talk, even after so long in the group. She also seemed

frightened of him, at least in the beginning, as she was of all men.

'You connected with each other, you shared a similar reluctance to engage with society?' the therapist said, always seeking to boil down life into something that might not sound out of place in an academic journal.

'We eventually got talking,' Jens said.

Jens had put it down to serendipity, but it had been a strange kind of serendipity. He had been on his way to group when his car wouldn't start. The dashboard had said the battery was depleted--and yet, Jens had a very strict routine, so he knew he hadn't forgotten to connect the car up to the charging station outside his apartment. The charging station had failed. He reported the problem--but then he either had to miss group, or face the germ-laden awfulness of the bus.

On the bus, pressing his eucalyptus oil soaked handkerchief over his mouth and nose, he'd seen Effie take a seat a few rows in front of him. His mind had been on other things--the little wad of used chewing gum jammed in the corner of the window next to him, the faint smell of cigarette smoke in the air, the filth encrusted on the seat in front of him, the sense that he was probably sitting on thousands of microbes carrying the flu virus--so, at first, he didn't notice that a group of young men up at the front of the bus were trying to hit on Effie. But they were talking and laughing so loudly while getting up from their seats to show off that eventually there was no way to avoid noticing them. When Effie showed no interest, it seemed only to wind them up further. It was beginning to turn nasty, Jens could see. He could also see Effie curling up in a ball on the seat, pulling her knees up under her chin and her hood down over her head. She was even shaking a little.

Jens wasn't quite sure how he had managed it. He remembered that it had taken every ounce of his strength and courage to stand up and walk to the front of the bus to confront them.

After that, Effie always sat with him at group. It was certainly good reward for his bruises. With his car working again, Jens would swing by her place near the university each week, and give her a lift to the community center. They didn't talk much to begin with--but they didn't need to. They smiled at each other. She seemed to relax around him, something she didn't seem to do around anyone else. And she seemed to realize very quickly that Jens's sensitivity to people and the world around him meant that she would do well to wear no perfume, and she even took to using scent-free toiletries before getting in his car each week.

'It says in your notes that you believe she's made a lot more progress than you have, since you started your group sessions,' the therapist said.

'She's done very well,' Jens agreed. Was he envious of her? Perhaps he would be if he could conceive of a world in which he wasn't so revolted by people around him. He didn't envy the fact that she went to work in an ordinary office, that she was around ordinary people much of her day, that she occasionally had to travel to faraway places and stay overnight away from home, to deal with things that were not routine.

'So tell me: have you ever been... *intimate*... with your wife?' the therapist asked now.

'No,' Jens said, without hesitation. But then after a brief pause, he seemed to think some kind of justification was required, and added: 'She never expected it--she knew from the start how it would be.'

'Your arrangement...?' the older man prompted.

Jens gave a curt nod. 'She was making better progress than me--she was able to be around men. Even back when we were just starting to talk about getting married, I thought there might come a time when... she would want to be... intimate... with a man again.'

'So what was your arrangement?'

'That if she... felt the need... she could do what she needed to... you know...'

'You're saying you would let her have an affair if she wanted one?' the therapist prodded.

Jens drew in a deep breath, then gave another nod. 'I can't do as she needs,' he sighed. 'And she knew that.'

There was a long silence, and Jens wasn't sure if the therapist was waiting for him to say more, expecting him to say more, or whether he was simply putting down his observations on the page. He did seem focused on whatever he was writing. Jens could hear only the scratch-scratch-scratch of the man's pen. All that handwriting--somehow it seemed so old-school now. Everything in modern life was tap-tap-tap at a keyboard.

Then the therapist stopped writing, and calmly looked up at Jens. He said, 'It is unusual, in a case like yours, that you connected like that with someone else--that it even went so far as marriage. Particularly before you had your condition under any kind of control.'

Jens shrugged. 'We trusted each other--and only each other. And when all was said and done, we were looking for some kind of permanent thing...'

'You wanted stability in your lives. *That's* understandable,' the therapist nodded. 'And routine, that makes you comfortable. The guarantee of a permanent routine...'

'We did love each other,' Jens pointed out. 'We just--I just--knew we couldn't have the kind of physical relationship that I--'

'But you knew early on that she would want a physical relationship?' the therapist asked him, peering over the top of his glasses. 'You knew it enough that you discussed with her the need for her to have the freedom to have a physical relationship with somebody else, after you were married?'

Jens sighed again. 'Even after what she went through... she still had sexual desires. She wasn't entirely comfortable getting close to anyone, and she was deathly afraid of men, but she still... you know... had needs.'

'She told you this while you were dating?'

'When we were getting serious about each other. When it came time to consider... you know... commitment.'

'She told you she would need something more than you could give?' the therapist asked him.

Jens smiled. 'She always said--when we were talking about getting married--that she wouldn't need to, that she didn't need another man. But sometimes, very occasionally, I would see her notice an attractive guy, and I could tell she was interested in him. That there was a part of her that responded to him. Sexually.'

'And did that upset you?'

'Not at all. I trusted her. I didn't think about anything to do with sex myself, with her or anyone else, so it didn't bother me that she might occasionally get the hots for somebody else. It was as if she had discovered a book she really liked, or a movie she really loved.'

The therapist nodded. 'But you knew enough to envisage that she might, someday, need some kind of sexual release?'

'I read a lot. I watch TV. Women in the media... they're not afraid, anymore, of talking about their sexuality, about their desires, their needs... I knew she had needs. Before we started dating, when she was still nervous of men, she dated women.'

The therapist's face remained impressively neutral. Not a hint of judgement anywhere in his grayish features.

'She told you that?'

'She mentioned it to the group, once or twice. And occasionally, I would see her leave the Frihavnskirken center with somebody.'

'And it never made you question why she might want to date a man, someone like you?' the therapist asked.

'To start with, I didn't really know it was dating. We just hung out together. Spent time together. Later, we went to meet her family... and

she introduced me as her boyfriend.'

'You met her family?'

Jens smiled. Nodded. 'It was... difficult. She has a large family. I couldn't... it was too much...'

'What happened?'

'She just told them I was sick. Put me to bed. We left, quietly, without much fuss the next morning.'

The therapist sighed, empathizing.

Another pause. Jens watched through the window as a flock of geese flew slowly, majestically by, dipping down to skim over the waters of the Peblinge So.

The therapist said, 'So now you believe your wife is considering having an affair. You don't think she's ever done it before and maybe you just didn't know about it?'

Jens thought for a moment or two. 'It's possible,' he nodded. 'I don't think so, though. The way she's acting now... she's never really been that way before. It's not just the washing machine...'

The older man cleared his throat. 'Uh... the washing machine?'

Jens took a deep breath. This was personal stuff. But if you couldn't tell your therapist, who could you tell?

'Our washing machine broke,' he explained to a rather baffled-looking therapist.

'Your washing machine broke?'

TECHNICAL FAULT

As a happily married couple, they had their routine. It worked. They weren't, however, fully prepared for when the routine was disrupted.

Normally, Jens came home from work first. Once safely ensconced in their apartment in the Osterbro district, just north of the city center, he would wash his hands at the kitchen sink, strip off all his clothes, put them in the washing machine, and switch it on to do a half-load. Then he'd step under a hot, hot shower and rigorously scrub the day's grime from his skin and his hair with the usual scent-free products. Then, once completely clean from head to toe, he'd put on crisp, freshly laundered nightwear before settling down to a plate of warm quiche and salad in front of the television.

Effie tended to work later, and arrive home after him. These days, since her promotion, she had settled into a routine where she would arrive home two full hours after he did, at about 8pm. The increase in pay justified her longer hours, at least in her mind. For Jens, it worked to help him be out of her way as she changed out of her clothes and put them in the washing machine while his were now drying. She would also immediately hit the shower before putting on clean nightwear and settling down to some food.

'Hey sweetie, how was your day?' she'd ask him, before sitting opposite him on the couch to tuck into the same, bland, largely scent-free supper as he'd had earlier.

'Good. I think I've nearly perfected the Rose D'Or.'

'Wonderful. You'll have to bring me home a sample when it's done.'

'How... was your day?' he had to remember to ask her. It bothered her when he forgot, when he was too introverted.

'Great--I hit my targets early. A few of us might go out for a drink tomorrow night, if that's okay.'

'Of course.'

When Effie went out at night after work, or if she had to stay particularly late at the office, their routine adjusted. But, as it still followed a regular pattern, so Jens was not troubled by it. If Jens was in bed by the time she got home, Effie would go up to the swimming pool on the top floor of their apartment complex, and that way she wouldn't need to wake him to take a shower. After her swim, she'd put on fresh clothes she kept in a locker up there in the women's changing room, and she'd return to the apartment, put her dirty clothes in the washing machine and quietly slip into the bedroom. Jens didn't mind the faint smell of chlorine about her after she'd had a swim. He had always associated that smell with cleanliness--his subconscious certain that the chlorine killed the bugs that crawled on a person's skin.

'But you were saying that your washing machine broke?' the therapist prompted him.

'That's right.'

'And I take it, this washing machine is a cornerstone of your daily routine with your wife?'

'You could say that.'

One day Jens came home to find that the damn thing just wouldn't switch on, no matter what setting he tried. Frustrated, he tied his dirty clothes up in a plastic garbage bag and dropped it beside the washing machine. Then he emailed the building super about the problem, and texted a warning about it to Effie, who had been out that evening with her co-workers, celebrating hitting their monthly targets. That night after her swim, she had also tied her dirty clothes up in a plastic bag and stowed it with his.

The next day the washing machine still hadn't been repaired when Jens came home. With another day's clothes sealed in a plastic bag, he had been so irritated that he'd had to sit down and fire off another email to the building super before he had even taken his evening shower.

Then later, while he was sitting down in front of the TV eating his dinner, he had noticed the unusual smell of women's perfume.

At first, he had tried to ignore it, his theory being that a new member of the building's cleaning staff had not yet been briefed about his strict no-perfume rule when tending to their apartment. Then, when he took his plate back to the kitchen area, he noticed that the smell wasn't all over the apartment, as might have been the case if a cleaner had simply been

wearing perfume. It was from one particular location--the laundry waiting to be washed.

'Wait, let me understand this,' the therapist said. 'Your wife avoids wearing perfume because it makes you feel uncomfortable.'

'That's correct.'

'And yet your job is, if I'm not mistaken, developing new perfumes?'

Jens nodded. 'When I'm working, it's in very controlled conditions. The amounts of scent I deal with are very small--I only need a very small amount to operate. And I know exactly which substances I'm dealing with while I'm working with them.'

'I see.'

Jens sighed, wishing that his new therapist might be a little more supportive and a little less judgmental. He said, 'When I deal with perfumes in my work, I'm dealing with very pure substances, drawn from very clean containers in a sterile environment. When you detect perfume on a person... what you are smelling is the perfume spread over their skin. The fragrance is designed to blend with, and conceal, their natural scent...'

The therapist nodded in understanding.

'So, when your washing machine broke, you discovered, what, that Effie has been wearing perfume at work?'

'Not when she's at work,' he said. 'When she goes out at night with her friends, or her co-workers. With our routine... she was always able to take a swim and then put her clothes straight in the washing machine--'

'So you never detected the perfume on her before?'

'No.'

'So she might have been doing this for some time?'

Jens nodded. 'Possibly.'

'What is the significance of her wearing perfume?' the therapist asked him. 'I mean... a lot of people would wear perfume when they're socializing like that.'

'When we started seeing each other, I once asked her whether it annoyed her that I was so sensitive to things like perfume,' Jens explained. 'She said she didn't need to wear it if the only man she was trying to impress was me.'

The therapist peered at him over the top of his half-moon spectacles. He said, 'So now that she's taken to wearing perfume again, you're of the belief that it's because she's trying to... impress another man?'

'That is my impression, yes.'

'And that... upsets you?'

Jens frowned briefly, but said, 'No. Not at all. Because we have our arrangement.'

'Of course, your arrangement.'

'Yes. I mean, I understand most people have needs when it comes to... well, sex. Women. Men. People can choose not to, but a lot of people still... need it.'

'So she knew full well that, as far as you were concerned, if she wanted to sleep with someone else... she could?' the therapist asked him.

'That *is* what I said--while we were dating, while we were preparing for the wedding,' Jens said. 'She always told me, when we talked about it, that she didn't need anyone else, that she was happy with me, even if it meant missing out on certain things. But I got her to agree that if, one day, she did... feel the need...'

'And if she did feel the need,' the therapist asked him, 'would she have to talk to you about it? Ask your permission?'

Jens shook his head. 'It was... we agreed that she should simply go ahead and... well, that I didn't need to know. That it would be easier that way.'

'As far as you know, has she ever... taken up the offer?' the therapist asked him, peering over his glasses again. Jens wondered faintly if the sexual aspect of all this was of interest to the man. If it thrilled him.

'Not as far as I know,' Jens said.

'But she could have?'

'She could have.'

That evening, Jens had torn open the plastic bag containing Effie's clothes from the previous day. He wasn't angry at her--he'd always said to her that she was free to take from other men what she couldn't get from him. Was he jealous? No, he wouldn't have said he was jealous, either. He was curious. He was interested. And he felt a strange feeling he hadn't really experienced much before.

He was turned on.

Kneeling there in front of the defunct washing machine, he held Effie's white work shirt up to his nose, breathing in deeply. Was he torturing himself out of some kind of masochistic need to punish his inability to give his wife everything she needed from a marriage? The smell was overwhelming at first. It did make him feel a little giddy, a little light-headed. But he got past that.

For some reason, he felt good breathing in the scent from her clothing. It was quite a surprise to him. He didn't feel ill, he didn't get a

headache. He didn't think about little microbes living in Effie's clothing. He was too distracted.

He knelt there, and his manhood was jutting up, rock-hard, between his legs. Goodness.

'In your mind,' the therapist said, 'this perfume on her clothing was indicative that she was... considering an affair. Not that she was already having one?'

'I wasn't sure at first,' Jens said. 'It needed further investigation.'

OBSESSED

Jens dropped Effie's shirt, and instead picked up her bra. It looked expensive, a luxurious pink satin, quite different from what she usually wore. He felt like a complete pervert--and yet the urge was strong in him to pick it up, to press it to his nose, to inhale and let the lingering remnants of her perfume fill his chest. It wasn't just her perfume that he detected, of course. There were other notes that he knew were not in the fragrance itself--he recognized it, of course, as Eve's Orchard, one of the more sophisticated products his company produced. There was a slightly musty, woody scent with a powerful overtone of sweet butterscotch--that could only be Effie herself, her personal smell.

He couldn't breathe it in for too long before he started feeling dizzy, and feared he might collapse--his nose was too sensitive, and unaccustomed to being used this way. But the big surprise was that he enjoyed her scent. It excited him like nothing he'd ever experienced.

It was a revelation, one of the biggest he could remember.

He was thinking perhaps he ought to come right out and tell Effie that it was okay if she wore a little perfume, that he'd be able to handle it. Or that she could get away with simply showering in the morning before she went to work, rather than in the evenings as well.

But was she wearing the perfume only to impress some guy she worked with? Jens knelt clutching Effie's clothes, sporting the most monumental erection, and the smell of Eve's Orchard made him certain Effie had come to the point where she needed intimate relations with a man, even if she had once abhorred all men.

And somehow, that made Jens feel even more excited--so much so that he came, right there and then, kneeling there in his pajamas. It made him feel so good, so warm, so contented--all for a few seconds. Then, as

the rosy glow faded, and his cock softened again, he was aware of the horrible wetness that had spread all over his lap. Wet, sticky, and soon enough in this chilled, air-conditioned apartment, it was cold.

Oh, so embarrassing. And just disgusting.

Somehow he avoided nausea--probably because he was coming down from an enormous high. But he knew he had to hurry before he started feeling ill. He stripped off his clothing and stuffed it in yet another plastic bag, sealing it up ready to wash once the machine was fixed. Then he took another shower. He was just praying that Effie would be a little late--she'd be curious why he was taking such a late shower, and perhaps she'd realize that it was his second shower of the night. Under the flow of the water, he worked out a cover story--he'd spilled his dinner, or something like that.

So embarrassing.

By his standards, it was a quick shower. But then when he shut off the water, he heard the unmistakable sound of the front door closing, and his stomach dropped.

'Hey, honey!' came Effie's voice.

He didn't answer--he was furiously drying himself off with a towel, trying to get his cover story straight, but the problem was that there simply wasn't any evidence that a spill of his food had occurred--no kitchen towels with food over them in the garbage, nothing. He didn't feel comfortable lying.

'Oh my God!'

He bumped straight into Effie as he was coming out of the bathroom--and she was naked, completely naked. She had been so quick at stripping off her clothes, he hadn't had a chance to even get out of the bathroom.

'Oh God, I'm so sorry!' she exclaimed.

Jens was a little stunned at first. Stunned by all her exposed golden skin, her breasts, her stomach, her legs, the little dark triangle of hair between her legs. Stunned by the strong burst of her perfume when he breathed in, along with her own personal smell, that butterscotch goodness. Wow. It was almost too much--almost. And despite his shower, despite what had happened when he'd breathed in her scent from her clothes, his erection was coming back. He just had time to hide it with his towel before her eyes dropped that far down his body.

She was wearing the same perfume again. Eve's Orchard. It made him snap to the conclusion that she had been trying to impress guys in

her office--or someone in particular. And it only made his manhood firm up more quickly.

'I'm sorry,' he said at last, when his tongue unfroze. 'I didn't mean--'

'Are you... is everything okay?' she said, taking a step back, fearing he might have a panic attack since she hadn't yet showered from her day at work.

'Yeah... I just... I spilled something,' he said, holding that towel firmly in place. Stepping back, Effie only made it easier for him to see the full beauty of her naked body, and it only made him feel more of that strange arousal he wasn't really used to.

'I could... I could take a swim upstairs instead?' she offered.

'No, it's okay,' he shook his head, and took a tentative step out of the bathroom. Why did he have the strong urge to bury his head between her breasts? To breathe in that intoxicating scent directly from her skin. 'I'm done in there now.'

She smiled, and took a step forward, and they did a funny little awkward dance as she tried to step around him, and he moved the wrong way to try to accommodate her. He breathed in another chestful of her scent, and it took just about all his concentration to conceal his reaction.

'They didn't fix the washing machine, yet?' she said.

'No, there's a part they need to order in.'

'That's awful--are you going to be okay?'

'I think so. I'll be all right.'

She wasn't particularly trying to hide her nudity, and he supposed it was because she didn't see him as any kind of threat, any kind of risk. He had no libido, in her eyes. He was just her best friend, nothing more. But Jens watched her slowly walk into the bathroom, her hips gently tilting with each step, her gorgeous buttocks moving in such an irresistible way. He was confused, but pleasantly so. He'd seen glimpses of her naked body before, but hadn't ever responded like this. Admittedly, it had only ever been from afar--it had never been like this, up close. And she'd always been clean, scent-free.

'You know, I could take all those clothes to a laundry place, get it done,' she said from the bathroom. 'And maybe it would be easier if I just go take a swim as soon as I get home from work--you know, keep my clothes up there until the washer's repaired.'

'No, it's okay. I'll be okay,' he said. It struck him as odd that he really did think he'd be okay--his normal self would be having fits that the washing machine wasn't repaired the same day it stopped working.

Effie's perfume lingered in the bedroom air for a few moments until fading in the air conditioning. It gave him such a strong suspicion that she was in the process of trying to seduce someone--and that, strangely, turned him on the most.

She was in the shower, he could hear the sound of the water falling. She would be there fifteen minutes, easily.

Jens crept out into the main living area and found her day's clothes all bundled up in a plastic bag by the defunct washing machine. He carefully untied the bag, just about managing to avoid ripping the plastic, then pulled out some of her clothes. Her top was soft, silky, and when he pressed it to his nose it smelled wonderfully of her. Maybe this was progress. Maybe he should tell her he had achieved some kind of breakthrough.

He just didn't know how to tell her that his progress had been spurred on by her use of perfume, that it had been prompted by the strange sense inside him that she was now in the process of dating another man. That felt wrong, humiliating.

Putting his hand back in the bag, he was startled as his fingers brushed over something damp. He winced, and his stomach churned. Had she had some kind of spill that evening? On the way home from work, perhaps?

He told himself it was probably only water, that she had spilled bottled water on herself as she had taken a drink. He calmed himself down, telling himself it was nothing to worry about--and yet, as he pulled the little black item out of the bag, it appeared to be Effie's underwear, her panties, and how could you spill bottled water on your underwear, particularly if you were wearing pants to work?

Here was a new smell: musky, earthy, with subtle sharpness like a fine, white wine. Was it perspiration? It seemed too strong. There was a hint of her perfume, of course, and her personal smell, but a whole lot more--and it had the strangest effect on him, only increasing his feelings of arousal as he considered this was the scent of her sex. He wasn't wholly naive about women. He realized this was evidence that Effie had been highly aroused herself--was somebody in her office having that effect on her?

How long did he sit there, teasing and taunting himself with her clothing? He heard her switch off the shower, and then it was a mad scramble for him to stuff her clothes back in that bag, tie it up, then slip back into the bedroom to grab fresh pajamas.

'Heading to bed already?' Effie said as she came out of the bedroom, one towel wrapped around her body from knees to armpits, another wrapped around her hair.

Jens was attempting to look as calm and collected as possible, but had only made it as far as his bed before Effie had emerged from the bathroom--so he could accept why she would think he had decided to turn in for the night.

'Yeah--just really tired,' he said. 'The boss has had us working really hard on this new fragrance for young adults. It's difficult to get right.'

'Is it like one of those awfully sweet ones that come out endorsed by some kind of teenybopper pop star?' Effie chuckled.

He watched her stand in front of the full-length mirror at the foot of the bed, pulling open the towel on her body to dry herself some more. Jens couldn't help but look for glimpses of her nakedness--God, he was becoming obsessed.

'Yeah, something like that,' he said. 'If they get a celebrity to put their name to it... well, that's for the marketing people to decide, I suppose. We're just formulating a product. I'm not sure we're big enough to get a big star, though.'

She laughed at that. 'Maybe Sarah, huh? Or Christine Milton. Or Caroline -- does it have to be a pop star?'

He had no idea.

She just looked so delicious--every curve seemed designed to provoke a response in him. Why had he never felt this way about her before? His theory was that his overall fear of being disgusted by her, as he was by most people--their dirt, their smells, their touch--had made him avoid looking at her like this, avoid engaging with her in any way that might risk problems. But now, suddenly, he felt oddly confident that nothing about her could disgust him--that she was the complete exception to the rule.

For a moment, she saw him looking at her in the mirror, and smiled. He looked away, and felt himself blushing. Had she caught him? Had she noticed him staring at her like that?

'Oh, I nearly forgot--I'm going out for drinks with a few people from work tomorrow night,' she said, apparently not noticing anything particularly amiss about his staring at her.

'Oh, okay,' he said, and felt his cock thickening again within his pajamas--as the thought struck him: is she really having drinks with a 'few people', or is this a date that she's keeping secret from me?

'I know, twice in one week,' she laughed, perhaps a touch self-conscious.

'It's no problem,' he said, offering her a relaxed smile as he covered his crotch with his hands.

He couldn't remember when she'd gone out twice in such quick succession, but it made Jens feel fairly certain that Effie hadn't done this before, she hadn't been interested in another guy before, she hadn't been ready to embrace her sexuality.

'Do you think it's just the fact that your wife is now ready to start having sexual intercourse that has had this effect on you?' the therapist asked him at his next session. 'I mean, there are theories about pheromones. Perhaps you're just reacting to the changes within her because she's finally becoming sexually active again...'

Jens shook his head. 'I don't think that's all of it,' he said. 'I mean, it's possible that might be *part* of it, but really... it's knowing that she's in the process of seeing someone else. For some reason I just... respond to that. Physically.'

'You're not 100% certain that she is seeing someone else.'

'I kind of am.'

'She told you?'

'I saw for myself.'

THE DATE

It felt wrong, what he did. But then it felt wrong that Effie would go out on a date with some guy from work, and that she wouldn't breathe a word about it to her husband.

Jens knew, well enough, that when they'd talked about it originally, he had said he wouldn't want to know about any of it, that she should just go ahead and tend to her needs, and not let him know about what was going on. But things had changed now. It felt wrong that she would do something so significant behind his back--that she should feel the need to tell even a white lie to cover up the truth of what was happening.

She didn't have to tell him she was going out for a few drinks after work with a few people. That wasn't the truth. And yet... he didn't blame her. It was what she felt she had to do to keep up her side of the arrangement, as they had discussed it.

'It sounds to me as though you just need to talk to her,' his therapist said. 'Tell her things have changed. You don't want her doing things behind your back anymore.'

'I guess I do worry that if she does tell me, I won't want her to do it. I'll have some change of heart.'

'But what you did... it's clear you do want to know, isn't it? Otherwise you wouldn't have been sneaking around like that.'

At the end of the day, after his decontamination routine, he had driven around to Effie's office in his i3 electric car, and parked it opposite the entrance lobby of her building. He wasn't worried about her spotting his car, even though it was a fairly unusual vehicle, being electric-powered with zero tailpipe emissions. His car was black, like many others around, and Effie knew nothing about cars.

It wasn't long after seven that she emerged from her building--and she wasn't with a group of friends on the way to get drinks somewhere.

She was accompanied by a single guy--a man who appeared to be perhaps a few years older than her; tall with very short blonde hair, a light stubble on his well-cut jaw, blue eyes. Effie was dressed much more seductively than her normal work attire. A very short pinstriped skirt was almost completely hidden under her jacket, with knee-high boots hinting at her long, sexy legs.

Effie didn't exactly link her arm in his, as they walked to the curb and he flagged down a silver taxi that had its green sign lit. Yet there were lots of smiles, lots of laughter, and plenty of flirting. It ignited the fires inside Jens's chest to watch her with him. She liked him, that was clear enough. Was this the man who made her panties damp?

He thought he'd feel jealous--but it really wasn't jealousy. He didn't feel anger that Effie was interested in this guy. He felt happy for her, that she might get to experience a normal sex life, and that this guy would make her feel good about herself. That maybe he'd even help her with the next step in putting distance between herself and her past trauma.

It was a little difficult keeping up with the taxi in all that early evening traffic heading across the harbor into the city center--and, a couple of times, he nearly thought he'd lost them, that suddenly his eyes had switched to a different car and they'd driven off. But then they headed north, past the royal palaces of Amalienborg and back down to the water, where a single-story building housed a restaurant by the quayside. Jens paused long enough to make sure they went inside, then went off to find somewhere to park.

'I know that place,' his therapist said. 'Toldboden. You followed them inside?'

'I did,' Jens nodded. 'It was a pretty lively place, a lot of people sitting outside, drinking, eating. Enough people around that I could be there and not be noticed.'

'You were okay there? I mean... all those people.'

'It wasn't too bad. I was surprised. I think I was so focused on tracking them... but I do always have my eucalyptus oil with me.'

The truth was, he hadn't been able to stay too long. Even with the eucalyptus oil blocking out most the smells, he wasn't comfortable being there. Every time someone passed by him, he felt nauseous. The smell of beer on the air -- and if he went outside, the marine tang in the air made him think of dirty ships and the industry located all around the harbor.

And yet, for a while, it was worth it to be there--to watch Effie with her friend, continuing their flirtation, both of them obviously into each other, though, it seemed, at the very early stages of a relationship. There

were a few touches, hands on shoulders, upper arms, and lots of eye contact, but at the same time they were being very courteous to each other, as if aware that they were co-workers, that if things went sour their work relationship would be affected.

Jens felt proud, that another man wanted her, and yet she had married him. He felt a strange sense of altruistic generosity, that he had effectively allowed her to do this kind of thing, to explore a relationship with another man, without it destroying their marriage.

But beyond the positive values, deep down he felt a powerful sexual excitement--he wanted Effie to experience this guy, to seduce him. He wanted her to have a good time, to enjoy herself, to get well and truly fucked. God, what would it look like, to see her with him? To see them in bed together, exploring each other?

He coasted on his sexual excitement for a while, but it couldn't distract him forever. After a while, he felt a headache coming on, and as he became more accustomed to the sight of Effie flirting with her friend, he started to feel the nausea in his stomach more and more. The aroma of beer and frying food in the air made him feel queasy.

Outside, he found his car, and waited there for a few minutes in case the two of them came back out of the bar. When they didn't come out, he figured it was time to head home.

'Well that wasn't so bad,' the therapist said. 'You were just checking up on her. Making sure she was safe.'

'I was stalking her,' Jens said. 'I know I was.'

'It made you feel bad?'

'It made me feel guilty, I guess. Like, if I was unhappy with her doing this thing behind my back, why was I doing something behind hers?'

'So that was the end of it?'

'Not entirely.'

Back home, he'd showered and had his dinner, and put on a clean t-shirt and sweatpants. He'd felt an odd brightness, a natural high, to think that Effie was still out with her friend. And the longer she was out with him, the better Jens felt--the more exciting it was, although he did miss her. He felt certain that the longer she was out, the more chance there was that her date would be successful, that perhaps she'd go home with him, that perhaps she'd even sleep with him.

Jens went up to the swimming pool for a little exercise to distract himself. The cool water was good for calming him down. Afterward, he pulled himself out of the pool and headed into the men's changing room to dry himself off, shower and put his clothes back on. A quick check of

his phone made him disappointed: she'd sent three text messages to him, stating that she was on her way home, that she figured since it was late that he might be asleep, that she'd go take a swim rather than taking a shower that might wake him up. Then she texted to say she was home, and heading up to the pool.

Jens felt actual disappointment--it was only 11 o'clock. Surely that was too early for anything significant to develop with her date?

Then, as he sat there contemplating her text messages, he heard the door of the women's changing room open. It had to be her--and yet he didn't want her to know he was there.

'Why do you think that was?' his therapist asked.

'I think... I didn't want her to know her date had thrown off my routine. I might have to explain why I was behaving differently.'

'You might have revealed that you knew about her date?'

'Something like that.'

He listened to her changing--in the stillness of the pool area, he could hear a surprising amount. The rustle of clothing, the snap of the stretchy lycra as she pulled on her swimsuit. He had crept to the exit of the men's changing room, peering out just far enough to watch her walk out of the women's room in her black and pink one-piece swimsuit, pausing on the edge of the pool.

He caught his breath seeing her, how good she looked in that suit. They rarely swam together, they never went to the beach. He didn't get to see her like this.

His cock was thickening up again, just seeing her like that. Watching her hold up her arms above her head, bend her knees, lean forward and then dive gracefully forward into the blue water. Following her streamlined form as she glided through the water, almost to the other end of the pool before she came up for air.

He watched her swimming, and then after a long while he watched her climb out of the water, at the steps over the other side of the pool.

When she went back into the women's changing room, he was preparing to escape--she'd rinse off, and put on her nightwear up here, so he'd have enough time to get down there, to make it look as though he'd been asleep all the time. But he heard her stripping off her swimsuit, and it stopped him in his tracks. He found himself picturing her naked, and he wanted to stay. The shower was switched on, and she stepped under the water. He could hear her washing herself--she was very diligent about that. She knew how important it was to him--or at least, how important it had been. Somehow, things were different now.

He listened, and then caught a new sound. A quiet moaning. The sound of the water falling all over her changed, too. The moaning grew louder.

Driven on by his curiosity, and his arousal, Jens took a few more risks than he would ordinarily have done. He slipped silently out of the men's changing room, along the end of the pool, and then into the women's changing room. The sound of Effie sighing and moaning was louder still, and seemed to Jens quite beautiful.

Inside the women's changing room, one locker sat open. In front of it was a pile of her old clothes -- including that tiny little pinstriped skirt, something he definitely would have remembered her wearing before. The locker held her folded up set of her nightwear, and a bathrobe.

He looked around toward the shower, moving slowly, carefully, trying to avoid being seen. As with the shower in the men's room, this one was just a little tiled cubicle, with a plastic curtain drawn across. Jens crouched down on the floor and found he could see under the curtain to some extent, though Effie would not be able to see him looking from where she was, sitting up against the far wall, the water streaming all over her. He couldn't see a lot, but he could see she was sitting there with her legs apart, both hands down between her thighs, touching herself.

Jens's cock hardened fully. He'd never seen anything like this before. Effie was masturbating in the shower. Wasn't it risky? Someone else could come by, wanting to use the pool. It wasn't very likely, but it was a risk. Was this something she did often? It made sense to do it here, where she would believe she was safe from her over-sensitive husband.

He watched her a long while, so turned on by the sight of her, even if he could only see a fraction of her naked form under that shower curtain. Was she driven to do this by her date? It hadn't gone on long enough to turn into actual sex, but she was getting ready for a future date to do exactly that.

Jens cast his eye on the pile of Effie's clothing sitting there in front of her locker. He moved over there, picked up her shirt. He pressed it to his face and breathed in her scent--oh, but it was irresistible. She was irresistible. It put the hairs on the back of his neck up, just like it did at work when they'd finally perfected a new fragrance and he knew it was just right.

Underneath her shirt was a pair of panties. They were crimson, lacy, and unbelievably tiny. They were designed to impress, designed to be seen, designed to be peeled off her by an excited lover. Not Effie's usual

kind of thing. She must have at least hoped that her date would lead to sex--Jens felt his hard cock throbbing at the thought. He picked up the tiny scrap of lace and found it soaking wet. She'd been so excited, no wonder she'd had to come back after her date and hide herself away to relieve her tension.

Jens felt like touching himself, too, and that was rare for him.

Cautiously he held Effie's panties up to his nose, and took a tiny sniff, the kind he took when he was dealing with a particularly powerful scent in the lab. Even so, he was nearly knocked off his feet by it--the spiciness, the muskiness, the underlying sweetness. He found himself thinking about how that luxurious lace had been wedged up against her pussy while she'd thought about whether she'd soon get to fuck her blond friend from work.

Then he felt a jolt through his system, centering between his legs--a pulse of warmth and joy that for a brief moment made him feel utter contentment. When he realized what was happening, however, he recoiled in horror.

His hard cock bucked once, twice, and then as it continued he felt the liquid rise inside, spurting out into his underwear, soaking through his sweatpants.

Oh Jesus, no.

He dropped Effie's panties, but it was too late. He was coming, powerfully, in his underwear. Mess went everywhere. Somehow he managed to stifle himself, to keep from crying out. He hated that feeling of wetness spreading over his crotch, the warmth quickly turning to cold as the warm come was cooled by the air.

Silently, he made sure the pile of Effie's clothes looked as it had when she'd left it, and then he managed to escape before she caught him.

'It did turn you on, though, didn't it?' his therapist asked him as he recounted the story.

'It did. It was... too much. But I think I was so fired up anyway... I could just about cope...'

'We've got to take it as a positive sign, haven't we?'

Jens sighed. 'But I felt so awful about... about invading her privacy.'

'Well,' the therapist smiled, and peered at him over the top of his spectacles. 'You're learning,' he said. 'You can be forgiven, perhaps, for a few stumbles, a few mistakes along the way.'

'I'm not sure.'

'The important thing now is, don't you think, to talk to your wife? Perhaps it is time to try even some tentative first steps on the road to true

intimacy between you.'

'I don't know...'

'You can try, can't you? I mean, now that you've developed this new desire for her, and you've discovered a new tolerance for her physicality and the outward evidence of her sexuality.'

'I don't know how,' Jens said. 'I never learned how...'

'Talk to her,' the therapist said, and it seemed so simple to him. Jens envied him his simplified world.

'But I... I want her to keep dating her new guy...'

He felt embarrassed. There was something wrong with him--he'd always known that--but now it was something truly humiliating, something that might poison his relationship with Effie for good.

'Well, that is another issue, Mr Nielsen. Perfectly common, as it happens--particularly where husbands feel unable to fully satisfy their wives sexually.'

'What is it?' Jens asked.

'You're a cuckold.'

Jens stared blankly at the man.

'You enjoy the idea of your wife being unfaithful,' the therapist explained. The man's words seemed to explode as they hit Jens's ears. 'In modern practice, the term usually means that a husband is complicit in his wife's infidelity--he either knows about it, and does nothing to stop it, or else actively encourages his wife to commit adultery against him.'

Right there in the therapist's office, Jens felt his manhood thickening up. Oh God. How embarrassing. He shifted on the couch, trying to stop it, trying to avoid his pants tenting up in any obvious manner.

He said, 'And you say... it's common?'

The therapist nodded, and didn't appear too shocked. 'A lot more common than anyone in my profession knew about,' he said, chuckling. 'I guess it's taken the Internet to unveil its true scale--the Internet's wonderful ability to put people in touch with other people who share their proclivities.'

'Is there... a cure?' Jens asked, feeling a little foolish.

The therapist shook his head. 'It's just a fetish, Mr Nielsen. Some people might claim such a thing can be 'cured', but I don't think it can be. It's like some people used to think homosexuality could be 'cured'.'

'So...'

The man continued, 'It's nothing to be ashamed of, Mr Nielsen. Earlier theories suggested that the cuckold fetish was some form of

sexual masochism, but recent thought puts it more down to some kind of escapism.'

'Escapism?'

'You are merely looking to escape to a simpler existence--you have difficulty satisfying your wife, so you fantasize about other men doing it on your behalf. You want to relieve yourself of the burden of your own perceived inadequacy as a husband.'

'So what do you recommend I do about it?' Jens asked the man.

'Well...' the therapist took a deep breath, 'it strikes me that you could do with a little medication to help with your overall anxiety.'

'I don't like taking pills.'

'I realize that--it's in your notes. But even so, I wonder if it wouldn't help you with the progress you are making. If you are truly interested in connecting with your wife, you need to cut out some of the fear factor in what is going on. You are clearly making some good progress in how you're coping with your condition... I think it's time to really push that forward.'

'Yes,' Jens nodded, and felt a strong desire for change--perhaps a careful use of medication could help him. Then he asked the therapist, 'and what do you think I should do about... you know... the 'cuckold' thing.'

The therapist shrugged. 'I don't see it as harmful, Mr Nielsen. Talk to your wife, perhaps. Explain your feelings. Tell her of your newfound desire, but perhaps also that you still want her to spread her wings, as it were.'

'You're saying I should let her sleep with her date?'

'I'm saying you need to talk to her all about it, and both of you need to agree on a way forward.'

Jens sighed. 'I think it may be a little late. She's on another date right now. I think she might sleep with him this time, anyway.'

REVELATION

Heading out of the therapist's office, Jens received a text update from Effie.

(Effie): My friends are in serious party mood--think it's going to be a really late one tonight. You going to be okay if I stay out?

He winced at her little white lie, although he knew it was necessary considering their current agreed arrangement. And yet, nevertheless, he also felt himself hardening again, even while simply walking down the street to his car. It was exciting, thinking about her being out there, dating again. About the possibility of her having sex. The therapist had been entirely correct about him liking the idea of his wife being sexually satisfied, without the burden of having to do it, and probably fail, himself.

Reaching the i3, he uncoupled it from the charging point--the existence of which had entirely determined which therapist he was currently seeing--and texted back a simple reply:

(Jens): Of course, sweetheart! You have fun, stay out as long as you like, as long as you're safe.

What else was he going to tell her? Sweetie, please come home we need to talk about all this?

(Effie): You're the best xxx

No, he couldn't stop her date. This wasn't just about him making progress regarding her, this was also about Effie making progress in dealing with her own issues, and if she was about to sleep with a man for the first time in years, then she was making serious progress. He didn't want to derail that.

A car went by, down this relatively quiet street, and he flinched as the awful smell of diesel fumes hit his nose. For a moment, Jens doubled over and nearly vomited in the street. Oh God. But then the moment

passed, as did the nausea. He pulled out a clean handkerchief, and his little pot of eucalyptus oil, and got it ready in case another car swung by before he could seal himself up inside his own little air-conditioned vehicle.

He felt somewhat light-headed on the way home, but the best way he could find to distract himself from his nausea was to keep his mind on Effie--on Effie, and on her date. What were they doing right now? Having dinner somewhere? Drinks at a bar? Laughing and smiling and gazing into each other's eyes. Flirting like teenagers in love.

He pulled into his parking space in the lot beneath their apartment building, and when he got out of the car he had a full-on raging erection. He had to quickly hide it from old Mrs Pollitt, who lived down the hallway, as he arrived at their front door.

Inside, he pulled off his clothes and put them in the washing machine, which was now repaired and working again. After a shower, he felt much better, at least physically. He was feeling a little nervous about what Effie might be up to. If she gave her date the hint that she was ready for sex, how long would they both stay out before deciding to find somewhere to do the deed?

After a bite to eat, Jens found the need to distract himself from Effie's date, and so he headed up to the gym for a rare mid-week workout. The gym formed part of his and Effie's weekend routine, but there was no reason not to use it on a mid-week evening. He told himself this wasn't about trying to step up his fitness regime, out of some fear that he might lose Effie to her date--although that was what some of his anxieties were about, weren't they? What if Effie went out with her new man, and then never came back to him afterward?

What if she had a taste of normalcy, and it opened up the promise of a future without the troubles of living with a man who had OCD?

But he couldn't think that way. He kept trying to block that thought. Effie loved him. She had chosen this life, she had married him when she could have kept away, she could have waited for a normal guy to come along instead. Deep breath.

There was a text message waiting for him after his workout.

(Effie): Having a good time--I'm not sure how late I'll be, you shouldn't wait up for me! Xxx

It was an unnecessary text message, because when Effie went out in the evening he never waited up for her. He went to bed, and she had her swim instead of a shower before eventually coming to bed herself. But

he felt uplifted by the fact that she had bothered to send him a text at all--it meant she hadn't forgotten about him, she was still keeping in touch.

He sent a reply:

(Jens): No problem! You have a wonderful time. Miss you! Xxx

That last part, about missing her, he'd never said to her before. It struck him as odd as soon as he sent it--but by then, he couldn't delete it, it had already been sent. He missed her. Normally, they had their strict routine, so there was no missing anybody. Right now, for the first time he could remember, he was actively yearning for her.

Eleven o'clock. This was the kind of time that a date might move on to something significant, he felt certain. Dinner was long gone, and there had been plenty of time for drinks after dinner. Was her text telling him not to wait up actually a subtle signal that she was about to go somewhere with her date--perhaps back to his place--to sleep with him?

Another shower. Another hard-on. He couldn't stop thinking about her date.

In a nice, clean pair of PJs, he tried to divert his attention by watching the TV, and then by playing *Call of Duty* on the PlayStation. He felt too restless even to enjoy shooting Nazis. He found himself thinking about what his therapist had said, found himself Googling the word 'cuckold'. There were 231 million results. It proved somewhat frustrating, however. The phrases that kept coming up suggested that if he was a cuckold, he wanted to be humiliated and degraded as his wife was taken by another man. That wasn't him at all.

With a little persistence, however, or at least long enough to get past the first page or so of the Google search results, he found entries that were more along the lines of how he felt. In particular, it was within recent articles on blogs and some magazine-style websites that things began to click.

'Being cuckold today means something very different from what it did when the word was first coined...' an online women's magazine stated, before explaining that the term used to refer to a man unable to keep 'his' woman from straying, or a 'fool' who did not realize his wife was cheating on him.

'We still use the word cuckold today, but it's less a source of mockery,' said the website, before going on to state that nowadays it simply referred to a man deriving sexual pleasure from his partner having sex with others who are not his partner, and that it was *'a really popular fetish, allegedly even in Hollywood.'*

Within the Google results, naturally there were plenty of links to porn websites and porn videos. Jens had never been a fan of pornography--the few glimpses he'd had in the past had struck him as rather crude and tedious, so he avoided those now. But there were also stories available, and he read some of those and did connect with them. Then he found a forum website, where husbands who described themselves as 'cuckolds', and their wives as 'hotwives', discussed their thoughts, feelings and experiences.

What struck him about the forum was the wide range of behavior that was all classed under the same 'fetish' category--there were men here that Jens envied. There were also men describing desires and experiences that Jens could not understand. Men who wanted to wear women's clothing as their wives cheated on them. Men who wanted to be humiliated by their partners and their partners' lovers. Men who wanted to join their wives in exploring other men. These were not for Jens--and yet, the variety of people who claimed to enjoy 'sharing' their partners did make him feel that while he might be different from a lot of them, he was not unusual, he was not a 'freak'.

He'd had enough of being seen as a 'freak', simply for wanting to keep away from other people, for washing his hands five times after touching anyone or anything he did not consider clean.

And importantly, it seemed, that many of the wives of the husbands on this forum who knew of their husbands' fantasies were supportive, or at least not judgmental. While some wives rejected their husbands' desires, it made Jens feel that perhaps, if he told Effie about his feelings, she wasn't the kind of person who would judge him, or ridicule him.

Midnight. God, she still hadn't returned. Something had to be happening.

Jens tried sleeping, to no avail. His mind was racing too much, and his manhood was too hard a lot of the time to allow him to relax. He got up, did some cleaning, though the apartment was always spotless. He found himself peering into Effie's underwear drawer, thinking about those 'date' panties she'd been wearing the last time she'd been out late. Was she wearing sexy lingerie tonight as well?

He'd never paid much attention to what Effie wore before, let alone her underwear. Now he found himself sifting through her drawer, and many of the items he saw were kind of sexy. Some of them he would definitely have described as 'date' underwear, and he wondered if she'd bought them recently, or if she'd always had something in reserve in case another man caught her eye.

It was probably a mistake, sifting through her panties. Imagining her wearing the sexy ones out on a date. Picturing another man peeling them off her beautiful body. Remembering how wet her date had made her the last time, and the strangely alluring scent of her arousal. He thought about it, and then even without touching himself, there was that familiar warm jolt between his legs, and his cock was pulsing as it spurted out his come.

It made Jens groan in frustration and embarrassment, and then dash to the bathroom to tear off his soiled PJs. It made Jens take yet another shower--a long shower--scrubbing frantically at himself to get himself clean again.

And while he was in the shower, he missed the text message from Effie that read:

(Effie): Hey, honey! Just got home--heading up for a quick swim before bed. Had such a good time tonight. Can't wait to see you again! Even though you're probably asleep by now Xxx

So when she did get back to the apartment after her quick swim, and slipped into the bedroom dressed in a little red tank top and white gym shorts, ready for bed, Effie ran right into a naked Jens as he came out of the bathroom after his shower. This was getting to be a regular habit.

'Oh, hey!' she said, a touch startled.

'Hey, I didn't know you were back,' he said, attempting a smile, but feeling himself blushing ferociously.

'I... you're still awake?'

She looked stunning. Ravishing. Even wearing her nightwear. Jens could see her nipples pushing against the thin material of her tank top, stiff as bullets. Had she really just had sex with another man? Had she really had his hands all over her, his lips, his cock inside her?

'How... was your date?' he said, hardly believing that he said it, but feeling himself resolve to open the communications between them, to end the kind of white lies that, later, might lead to bigger lies, damaging lies.

He saw her catch her breath, and then she seemed mildly afraid. 'You... knew about that?' she asked him.

Her confirmation only made his cock harder. He held his hands in front of it, but she probably only had to look downward to catch a glimpse of it.

'I figured it out,' he said, trying to sound relaxed, non-judgmental.

She took half a step back, and he hated that for the first time ever, she seemed to be afraid of him. 'Are you... upset?' she asked him. 'Are you

angry at me?'

He smiled, and said, 'No, not at all. Actually... kind of the opposite.' He figured, well, if he couldn't tell the truth to Effie, he didn't deserve her for a wife anyway--and he moved his hands away from his hard cock.

'Oh!' she exclaimed, genuinely shocked. And then she said, 'Oh...' softly, as though now she saw it, she desired it, her voice turned sultry and sexy. 'This is how you feel about me going on a date?'

He gave her a sheepish smile. 'Crazy, isn't it? My therapist says he thinks I might have some kind of a sexual fetish. Cuckolding, it's called.'

'I think I've actually heard of that,' she said with a slight nod, but she couldn't tear her eyes away from his big, hard cock.

She took her half step back toward him. He could smell the chlorine on her, from her swim. 'Can I touch it?' she said quietly. 'I have had a swim...' Then she looked up at him, and her expression instantly turned apologetic, as though she realized she would be offending him, she would be unsettling him, she might make him feel ill.

'Uh... maybe... yeah,' he said, offering her a nervous smile. His cock twitched a few times at the thought of her touching it, but he was nevertheless unsure about it. They didn't touch. The occasional, very brief hug, had been all, except for the briefest kiss--closed mouth--on the lips at their wedding ceremony. 'I think it might be okay,' he added, trying to seem more confident.

Slowly, she moved her hands together in front of her, and brought them between his legs, to cup his balls. He jumped a little as she touched him there, but then as the fingers of one of her hands gently curled around the base of his stiff shaft, he took a deep breath and was able to relax. It felt good--surprisingly good. Holding him like that, completely still, she looked up at his face to gauge his reaction. He did his best to smile, though the feelings flowing through his body were stronger than he was used to.

'I never thought you could,' she said quietly.

'Well, I guess I'm making progress too, huh?'

She smiled. 'And this is really because I went out on a date this evening?'

He nodded. She moved her hand on his cock, just a little stroke, but he caught his breath, it felt wonderful, he could hardly believe it.

'You okay?' she asked him.

He nodded again. Then he said, 'Tell me about your date.'

She looked him in the eye, raising one quizzical eyebrow. 'Are you sure?' she said. Then, as Jens smiled again, mildly embarrassed, she

moved her hand again, gently stroking, and this time she didn't stop. 'I guess this is telling me you do want to hear, huh?' She laughed. 'When we talked about this... arrangement... I thought you were fairly clear you didn't want to know anything about it.'

'I didn't know,' he said, his breathing accelerating along with his heart rate.

'So... how much do you want to know?' she asked him.

'Everything. I don't like it being a secret. I want to know.'

For a moment or two, she stared at his hard cock in her hands as she gently pumped his shaft. Then she said, 'Do you want to sit down? Make yourself comfortable?'

HER TOUCH AND HER TALE

She ushered him down onto the edge of her bed, the twin nearest the door to the en-suite bathroom, and then she sat beside him, reaching over to place her hand on the base of his cock. She was careful to sit slightly apart from him, an inch or so of space between their corresponding thighs, concerned that too much touching all at once would overwhelm him.

But she still put her hand back on his cock, enclosed his shaft in her fingers. It felt amazing.

'We're really doing this, huh?' she said, a beaming smile spread across her pretty face.

'Uh-huh,' he said, trying so hard not to come as she started stroking him again.

'And you're sure you didn't take a handful of Viagra just because you figured I was out on a date? Because if we're saying no secrets anymore...'

'No,' he grinned. 'I didn't take anything.'

'Mmm...' she said, gazing down at his hardness as she squeezed it and caressed it. 'You have the nicest cock, you know that? So big... and hard...'

She giggled as she felt him respond physically to her words.

'So you want to hear about my date, huh?' she said, and again his cock throbbed in her hand. 'I guess you don't need to answer my questions verbally.'

'No,' he returned her grin.

'And you're not... jealous or anything like that?'

He shrugged. He'd never really felt jealousy. He wasn't a jealous person, and Effie had never made him feel insecure in any way. He'd always thought that marrying someone like him wasn't something a

woman would or could do lightly, and that therefore she had to really care about him.

'I'm not jealous,' he said. 'I... like the idea that you could go out and have fun with somebody...'

'You do like it, don't you?' she said, indicating his seriously hard cock. 'So you want to know, what, his name? Who he is? How we met? What's going on?'

'Everything,' he said.

She nodded, and looked him straight in the eye, as though to assess him one last time for the possibility that he was leading her on, that he didn't really want to know, or that he couldn't handle it. Then she said, 'His name is Nicolai, he's a management consultant.'

Jens focused on breathing, on controlling the wonderful feelings her hand provoked in him--because too much of a good thing would soon mean it was all over, and he didn't want it to be all over too soon. But he thought Nicolai somehow didn't seem to fit the man he had seen her leave the office with at the start of her date.

'You're not sleeping with him to protect your job?' he joked.

She laughed. 'No, I wouldn't do something like that. Nicolai's just been brought in to manage our takeover of another company--we won't be losing any jobs on our side.'

Jens nodded. 'Is he... older than you?'

She tilted her head, uncertain. 'Maybe a bit. But he's nice. He's kind. He's fun.'

'He's good-looking?' he asked her.

She glanced up at him, again gauging him, making sure he wasn't trying to trap her, wasn't trying to get her in trouble. He wasn't.

'He is good-looking,' she said, and then giggled again as his cock twitched in her hand. 'I guess you'd say he's fairly tall, very short blondish hair. Blue eyes. He takes good care of himself, physically.'

'And this was, what, your first date? Second?'

She hesitated. Then, 'Third.' She sighed, and said, 'Sorry. But you said you didn't want to know--'

'I know I did. I was wrong.'

Now she brought two hands to his cock, to squeeze him, to stroke him a little harder--though it was still careful, still fairly gentle. She had wonderfully soft hands.

'Is this okay?' she asked him.

He nodded, and attempted a reassuring smile. 'So what happened on your third date?'

'Well... we went out for dinner... and then we had a few drinks at a bar nearby...'

She leaned into him as she worked on his cock, and her thigh came gently into contact with his. He suspected she didn't realize it, but he didn't mind. He was coping. Her leg was so warm, her gorgeous caramel skin so smooth. As she leaned over him, he could see down her tank top, a nice view of her cleavage--and he could see her nipples, so stiff pressing against the thin cotton.

And as she leaned into him, he could smell the chlorine of her swim, even after her rinse in the shower. He was also able to detect that other smell, faintly. Her personal smell--the scent that was unmistakably Effie, and nothing else. Mild, inviting, with a touch of butterscotch sweetness.

'What did you talk about?' he asked her.

'Work... politics... our childhoods,' she said. Then, 'Actually, I did tell him about you.'

'So he knows you're married?'

'I told him you can't... well, I guess I was wrong about that.'

'Not entirely wrong,' Jens corrected her.

She looked at him, hopeful, but also somehow happy with what she had. 'But we can work on this, don't you think?' she said, and he very much liked the implication that she wanted to work on this, in this particular way. 'I mean, this is amazing progress, don't you think?'

'I suppose so.'

'Maybe I don't even need to date someone else...'

She looked him in the eye again, and he smiled, 'I think it would be better for us if you did.'

She nodded, 'I guess so.'

Jens asked her, 'So Nicolai thinks... you're having an affair with him?'

She paused, as though considering the thought, and whether what had happened on their third date constituted an affair just yet. 'I suppose he does,' she said.

'So what happened after you had drinks with him?'

She took a deep breath. 'He... kissed me.'

Jens felt his cock jolt, and feared that she'd pushed him over the edge. But, somehow, he held himself back. Effie couldn't help but notice how he responded to her words, however. It amused her, but it also seemed to intrigue her--and maybe, as she got used to the idea, it excited her.

'You never kissed him before?' he asked her.

She shook her head. 'The first time I went out with him was just coffee... and the second time, I really wasn't sure about it at all, and I

think he could sense that.'

'But the third date, that was okay? You were sure about it?'

She smiled. 'I was sure about it until I came home to find my husband with this beautiful, hard cock.'

He moaned at the sensations she provoked in him, and when he glanced over at her, it seemed she was taking some kind of pleasure in doing it for him.

'So... he kissed you. And you liked it?' he prompted her.

She raised her eyebrow again, still unsure about whether he really wanted to know. 'I... did like it,' she said cautiously, and looked down, briefly, as she felt his response in her hands. Reassured, she went on, 'We went back to his place. He has a nice apartment overlooking the water, just down from Nyhavn.'

'Impressive.'

She smiled. 'He *is* a senior management consultant. Anyway, he opened a bottle of red wine, and we were talking about stuff... and I guess I knew what was coming, because then I was warning him about... you know... my history...'

'Your *history*?' he wasn't asking her what she meant, his tone of voice made it clear he was asking whether she had been really comfortable opening up to someone new about her past trauma.

'He made me feel very comfortable,' she said. 'Very... safe. Said we didn't have to rush into anything.'

'But he did kiss you.'

'I think, maybe, it was more like I kissed him. It was very nice. Soft. Sweet.'

For a moment, Jens wondered what it would be like to kiss Effie, properly. Perhaps it would be okay--he would enjoy the softness, the sweetness. Breathing in her own sexy scent as he kissed her. But he couldn't say for certain that it would be okay--his paranoia, which had been honed and perfected for three decades, might so easily turn his attention to the inherent hygiene issues associated with close contact with another person. If he saw the bugs... it would ruin everything, maybe sully their entire relationship.

Her hand wrapped around his cock was one thing, apparently, but his lips touching hers, his tongue touching hers... and all that saliva...

'You kissed his mouth?'

She nodded. Still looking into his eyes, still checking he was all right with this.

'He put his arms around me,' she said, 'and it felt so... nice. I let him. I wanted him. I wanted his hands all over me.'

Another glance at Jens's eyes, another quick assessment of his state of mind.

Then, 'I think... when he actually touched me--when he was stroking my breasts, he actually made me come.' She looked down at her husband's cock, and he was still so hard in her hands. 'We went through to the bedroom, and I helped him take off his clothes, and we were kissing some more... but then I pushed him down on the bed.'

'Uh-huh?' Jens prompted her.

'I guess I felt... self-conscious. I wanted to switch out the lights. I didn't want him to see me.'

'Why not? You're beautiful.'

She smiled at her husband's compliment. 'But he told me to take off my dress, and so I just had to. He watched me, and when I took off my dress he told me to take off my underwear. And when I hesitated, he took it off for me...'

Jens could hardly believe what she was saying, it was sexy like nothing he had ever heard before. It was sexy, and it was also shocking, even though they had agreed she could do it, they had their arrangement for Effie to pursue the sex she needed. As she continued stroking his cock, squeezing it, pumping it, Jens felt it harder and harder to breathe. And as he did breathe more and more deeply, it seemed that the scent of chlorine on Effie gradually faded, and her own scent became stronger--and that only seemed to turn him on more.

'...He had me lie down on the bed, and then he was just touching me--stroking me--all over my body. It was so nice... I just felt so guilty...I rolled over onto my front, so it would just be like he was giving me a massage...'

'Guilty?' Jens said, though he found it increasingly difficult to talk. His tone said she had nothing to feel guilty about, and that made her smile.

'I just kept thinking about you, and I assumed... nothing would ever happen between us. I tried to think of all those times you kept telling me I needed to do this--'

'You do,' Jens agreed.

'He was rubbing my back and it felt so good...' Jens wondered if she had reacted to Nicolai's touch so strongly because she'd been so starved of human contact through their whole marriage. '...And then he started planting little kisses all over my shoulders, down my back...'

Another glance up at her husband. Jens gave her a little smile of reassurance this time, though he was flushed and trying hard not to think about the fact that he was actually getting sweaty now, his pores opening up to expel hot salty fluid, so dirty...

'He kissed over my hips, and down my thighs,' she said, and he noticed that Effie was breathing quite heavily herself, those nipples so hard they were in danger of piercing her nightshirt. Was she getting turned on? Was he even able to detect the subtle aroma of her arousal, now that she was?

One more look into his eyes, and Effie said, 'Then he was lying between my legs, pushing up my butt, and he was... kissing me... down there... he buried his face between my legs and I felt his mouth, his tongue on my... on my pussy...'

Jens remembered how it had been to press her wet panties to his face, and now he envied Nicolai, even though he wasn't sure he could ever do such a thing himself. And yet while there was envy, there was still no jealousy. No anger. He felt some kind of elation that the man had done this with Effie.

'It felt... good?' he asked her.

'A little... unexpected, at first. But good, yeah. Once I got used to it, very good. I couldn't believe it. His mouth was so hot, so soft, and when he sucked on me, it was like... I don't know... fireworks inside me...'

But that was where Jens reached his limit, and with a cry of horror, disgust, and also unavoidable pleasure, he felt his hard cock jumping in her hands, bucking like a mule--and spurting that awful, sticky, hot cream into her hands.

'Oh God... oh God...' he panted. 'I'm so sorry... I'm so... sorry...'

Effie only smiled, 'It's okay, that's the way it's supposed to be. It's okay, really.'

AFRAID

She got a towel to clean him up, and then while he went back into the shower, she put their clothes, and the sheets from the bed, straight into the washing machine. One thing with the routine was that there would always be plenty of freshly laundered replacements--their closets and drawers were full of identical sheets, and for Jens identical clothes, since he felt so comfortable wearing the same thing day after night after day.

Effie showered again, after Jens. A particularly long shower, even for her. He thought she probably expected him to go straight to sleep after what had happened. But he felt so alive, so content, his mind whirring so much, there was no way he could sleep.

After a while he heard, though it was very faint, her soft moans. It was barely there over the sound of the water, but Jens had heard it before, he recognized it instantly. Effie, his beautiful wife, touching herself.

What he would give to be able to just go in there, to join her, to touch her for himself, to make her feel good for himself. He'd made progress, though. That was a good thing. She'd seemed delighted by it. They'd had their first sexual experience together. He hadn't even felt ill after his come had leaked out everywhere, over his lap and over her hands.

And now, listening to her, he was thickening up again. Unbelievable. He was like a spotty teenager again. Perhaps because he'd missed out on fifteen years or so of sexual experiences.

He pulled himself out of bed, and walked out of the bedroom to the kitchen to fetch a glass of iced water. It didn't do much to calm him down. It was getting really late, but at least it was the weekend, he wouldn't have to go into work the next day. Finishing up the water, Jens noticed that the washing machine wasn't going. He sighed, thinking that

perhaps it had broken down again. But then approaching it, he saw that Effie hadn't pressed the 'power' button that final time. It took about three presses, which had never made much sense, but had never seemed like something worth complaining about to the building super.

He opened up the lid of the washing machine and for a moment stared at the mixture of sheets and pajamas and Effie's nightwear. Then he fished out a little scrap of black cotton--Effie's panties. The ones she'd been wearing while telling him about her date, while sitting on the bed with him, stroking his cock. They were soaking wet, and it was hard to avoid her scent, even before he brought them up to his sensitive nose.

Without hint of perfume this time, this was only Effie's arousal. It made him feel giddy, but in a surprisingly good way. He didn't feel bad, didn't feel nausea. It was exciting--proof of how turned on she'd been, telling him about her date, and perhaps from touching him, too.

He heard the sound of the shower being switched off, and now quietly closed the washing machine lid before pressing the power button one last time to set the thing going. Then he crept back into the bedroom and into bed just moments before she emerged from the bathroom.

'You never said how your date ended,' he pointed out, as though he needed to occupy her mind to make sure she didn't notice that he'd just dashed back into bed, and that he was suspiciously flushed and slightly out of breath.

She smiled, amused at his endless curiosity. 'That was about everything,' she said, stepping in front of the mirror to get dressed again. 'After he made me come that last time, we talked a bit, and then I said it was probably time I went home.'

'You didn't... reciprocate?'

She shook her head. 'I thought I would, but we were talking so long and then... he didn't seem to expect anything.'

He watched her drop her towel, saw her naked again in front of the full-length mirror, her long, black, curly hair tumbling down her back.

'You think you will, next time?'

'Next time?' she raised another quizzical eyebrow. 'I thought we were making progress?'

She smiled, amused at his apparent disappointment that she might give up dating her new guy, Nicolai.

'It's just sex,' he said, surprising her by how relaxed he was about it. 'You don't have to give up dating, just because... you know... we're making progress, too.'

She looked over at him, and after a brief pause as she stepped into clean panties, she said, 'You know I love you, don't you?'

He could tell she was slightly confused by it: for a man with such huge hang-ups about cleanliness, about human contact--he viewed sex as just another activity, something his wife might do with whomever she pleased, without any need to restrict it because of their marriage.

'And yet, you did feel shame about your emerging sexual attraction toward your wife,' the therapist said.

'Shame,' Jens said, mulling the word over in his head.

The therapist peered over his glasses at him. 'You know, most husbands in your position would celebrate the fact that you are not only making progress in regard to dealing with the physical presence of another person close by to you--but you're also, apparently, discovering that you are actively attracted to Effie, and even turned on by the physical manifestations of her sexuality.'

The therapist chuckled. 'And, I'd say, most husbands would feel shame about the fact that they rather liked the idea of their wife seeking sexual gratification outside of their marriage.'

'Yes, maybe.'

'With you, it's completely the other way around.'

Jens thought about that night, as he and Effie had finally switched out the lights and gone to bed, after that first time she'd ever really touched him, the first time they'd shared a sexual experience together. He'd been a little surprised, lying there in the dark, to suddenly realize that he still had her panties clutched in one hand.

Had she noticed him holding them?

She hadn't acted as though she'd spotted them, as far as he could tell. In the darkness, he pressed her underwear to his face once again, breathing in that wicked scent. It had seemed so wrong, for him to do it--and the therapist was correct, it had felt shameful. He was invading his wife's privacy, he had taken something that wasn't his, he was sampling something of hers without her consent.

And yet, disturbingly, he liked it.

'Why don't you just tell her?' the therapist said. 'Tell her that you've come to enjoy the way she is, without needing her to scrub herself raw every night?'

'I... I don't know...'

The therapist nodded. 'You can't quite accept it yourself, can you?'

Jens looked blank.

'Or... perhaps you're afraid?'

'Afraid?'

The therapist nodded, as though the matter was already settled. 'Perhaps you're afraid that if you tell her that you like the way she is, naturally. That you're turned on by her body--that something you find so sickening in other people, you've come to desire in her. Are you afraid she'll expect you to be the lover she's missed out on ever since she married you? And that you might not meet her expectations in that area?'

'I... I don't know...'

The therapist smiled. 'You know, the pressure to perform sexually can be immense for many men. Many husbands.'

'It can?'

He nodded. 'It's a very common problem, leads to a lot of erectile dysfunction. I have many patients... well, I can't talk about specifics, of course...'

WATCHING HER

Saturday.

It was fair to say that with Jens knowing about it, her dating had somewhat accelerated. Instead of waiting until the following week for another quiet mid-week evening, Effie had a date arranged at the weekend.

This totally disrupted their routine--and yet Jens was fully on board. He even went to sit in the bedroom with her while she got ready for her date.

'Oh hey,' she said as she emerged from the bathroom after her shower. 'Everything okay?'

'Of course,' he smiled. 'I just wanted to spend time with you before you go out.'

Stopping in front of the mirror, she smiled. 'I don't have to go out, you know. I could stay here with you tonight if you prefer.'

'Oh no, I want you to go out. I want you to have fun.'

She paused until her eyes connected with his through the mirror, and she knew for absolute certain he did truly want her to go out on her date.

'You're going to get bored watching me getting dressed,' she warned him.

'I doubt it.'

He watched her drying herself, his eyes running over her sweet curves, over all her wonderfully smooth skin. He'd always appreciated her beauty--but it had always been a very clean appreciation, like a critic admiring a masterpiece artwork. And yet now it was different. The thought of her dating another man had awoken a new appreciation inside him, a sexual appreciation. Now he hid an erection while he sat there on his bed, watching her drop her towel and reach for the little pile of clothes on the chair by the mirror.

He watched her, and despite his fear of touching her, of being too near her, he wanted to put his hands all over her, feel how smooth and soft her skin was, and find out how her body responded to his touch. Despite his concerns about how he would cope with any kind of human contact, a big part of him wanted to rub his face against her body, to breathe in her scent from the source, to experience her physicality right up close.

'I'm not used to you watching me,' she said, but she was amused by it, rather than put off by it.

'I can sit out there, if you'd prefer,' he said.

'It's okay.' She held up a tiny little item in front of the mirror, and he saw it was a pair of panties--black, very small, and very elaborate in lace and sheer mesh. She stooped, and lifted one leg and then the other to put on the panties, and his eyes followed her every move.

Nicolai--the man she worked with--was going to get to peel those panties off her. They were already semi-sheer, but as she stretched them into place over her hips, it struck Jens how they were designed to tantalize a lover, they weren't designed just for a woman to wear and keep hidden.

'Do you like watching me?' Effie asked him.

Her nipples were so stiff, riding on her perky breasts. He couldn't believe how much every detail of her body seemed perfectly calibrated to turn him on.

'Oh, yes,' he said, feeling strangely excited to admit it to her. Like therapy, somehow it felt surprisingly good to talk about this stuff. In the same way that it was cathartic to discuss your personal problems with someone else--just getting your thoughts out there, somehow, made them seem less awful, and made you feel more confident in dealing with your problems. In the same way, he got a similar feeling that admitting his sexual desire to Effie was helpful, rather than humiliating. 'Do you mind me watching you?' he asked her.

'I like it,' she smiled, and gave him a little twirl to show herself off for him. 'I just didn't think you were interested in... this kind of thing.'

He laughed. 'I didn't think I was, either.'

'But you are now?'

He moved his hands from his lap, and showed her the big tent in his pants. She caught her breath, covered her mouth with her hands as though shocked, but her dark eyes seemed absolutely delighted.

'Do you want me to... help you with that?' she offered.

He shook his head. 'Not until after your date.'

She brushed her hair back with both hands, and it only showed off her magnificent breasts, her sensational curves, all the better. 'Maybe I'll be trying for a shorter date, then,' she said with a mischievous glint in her eye.

But he said, 'No, you shouldn't cut anything short. I'll still be here for you.'

She smiled again, and reached for another item of clothing from the chair. 'You know, you make it harder for me to go out and spend time with someone else.'

He chuckled, 'Just think about how much you like Nicolai, and how good he makes you feel when you go back to his place...'

Effie was facing him, putting one foot on her bed as she rolled a long, black stocking up her shapely leg. Her eyes were on his hard cock, however. She asked him, 'Do you ever... touch it... yourself?'

He shrugged.

'Even in the shower?'

He said, 'I don't... it's only really been recently I've been feeling this way.'

Putting on her other stocking, she said, 'If you tried in the shower, you might be okay with it.'

Wow. She looked sensational in those thigh-high stockings. Along with her panties--and next up, a matching black lacy bra--they emphasized the femininity of her lines, and drew his eyes over the perfection of her figure.

'You think he'll like it?' she asked him, and instantly regretted saying it--thinking that she'd made a bad joke.

But Jens said, 'Oh, he'll love it, I'm sure.' And the way she drew attention to the probability that Nicolai was going to see her in her underwear, and no doubt peel it off her, was such a turn-on.

'I could just stand here all night and give you a fashion show,' she giggled. 'And maybe you could try... you know... touching yourself...'

He laughed, though it was tempting. 'You're going to have a nice dinner,' he said, 'and then a few drinks... and he's going to take you back to his place and then he'll make you feel so good, you'll completely forget about me until it's time to come home.'

She took a stylish little black dress out of her wardrobe, and now pulled it on over her head, stretching it over her cleavage so the hem dropped down above her knee.

'You know I'm not going to forget about you,' she said. 'Not for one minute.'

But after she put on her makeup, she did very nearly forget about him to the point where she picked up her little bottle of Eve's Orchard from her bag, and almost sprayed it all over herself ready for her date.

'Oh, God, I'm so sorry,' she said, realizing her mistake just in time to stop herself.

'It's okay,' he said, though he was relieved that she hadn't sprayed it out.

Then, she was ready. She stood to attention, as though he had to inspect her like a general inspecting his troops.

'You look amazing,' he said, and made her smile again, something that was rapidly becoming his favorite thing to do in all the world.

'Oh, one last thing,' she said, and stepped over to her bedside table. From the little drawer, she pulled out a small square-shaped box. 'You never know, huh?'

Jens smiled, but didn't know what it was at first. Only after a moment or two, as he accompanied her to the door, did he realize. Then she gave him a little air kiss on the threshold--both cheeks--and was gone, leaving him feeling rather breathless as he considered the fact that his wife had just left home bearing a box of condoms.

He wasn't jealous, really. But he felt a little overwhelmed by the thought that she really was going to take another man inside her.

WAITING

Jens waited, and waited. He couldn't get the image of her in that little black dress out of his mind. She'd looked so glamorous, so sexy. It made him realize how conservative she had been before with regard to her fashion choices, as though she had never wanted to attract anyone's attention. He supposed that she had developed her fashion sense over the years while cringing at the thought of attracting any attention from men.

And now, she was out on the town with a new lover, wearing a dress with a plunging neckline, and which showed plenty of thigh--and underneath it she was wearing sexy black lace, semi-sheer panties and thigh-high stockings.

If anything, it felt stranger waiting for her this time. This time, nothing was unsaid. He knew she was going out on a date, and she knew he knew it. It made his head spin, knowing how excited she would be to have dinner with a man she was attracted to, knowing that later that evening she would get to enjoy him sexually. To know how good she looked, and how her lover would respond to her looking so stunning. To know that he was allowing her this experience. To know how strangely sexy it was to think of her coming home to him after having sex with another man.

How could he be so turned on by that idea, when it was plain that when she returned home, she would be defiled, contaminated by another man?

Whatever. Waiting for Effie while she was on her date was a confusing tangle of feelings for Jens--but one thing he could not deny was his overall excitement for what was going on. After she left the apartment, his hard-on didn't dissipate for a moment. He couldn't stop

thinking about her being out there, and so he couldn't get his erection to subside.

He took a cool shower, and as it did nothing to reduce the stiffness in his manhood, he was almost tempted to try touching himself--as Effie had tried to persuade him. She'd been right that if he was going to be comfortable doing that sort of thing, the shower would probably be the best place. The constantly flowing water, and all that soap, would take the edge off his concern about hygiene. But he felt stupid, standing there stroking his own cock under the shower.

How could he be standing alone, jacking off, while his wife was out seducing another man?

He wanted to wait for her to come back. He wanted his next sexual experience to be with her, if he was able to stand it at all.

Looking for a distraction, Jens went up to use the gym. It was usually empty later on in the evenings, particularly at the weekend, but to his mild consternation, halfway through his workout, a young blonde woman came in to use the gym as well. Ordinarily, if someone else entered the gym while he was working out, he would have instantly ended his own workout and escaped as rapidly as possible. But this time, he decided to test himself a little. He stayed right where he was on the rowing machine, and tried to manage his fears about another person using the gym at the same time.

Jens would have said the woman was a few years younger than he or Effie, in her mid-to late-twenties. He hadn't seen her before, but then as well as avoiding other people around the apartment complex, he rarely paid attention to anyone he did see. With her long, blonde hair tied up in a tight ponytail, she was wearing blue leggings that seemed painted onto her legs, a cropped vest that left her taut midriff bare, and a black hooded top that she now removed as she approached the elliptical machine.

She gave him a brief smile as she looked around to see if anyone else was working out, but then as she stepped onto the machine, she was facing away from him.

Jens tried to look as though he was still putting effort into his rowing, but in truth he was paying more attention to the presence of the young woman just ten meters or so away. It wasn't really that he was checking her out--although she was easy enough on the eye with all that tight clothing. He was challenging himself to see if he could remain there without his proximity to her causing him to feel ill.

As he watched her work out, he silently told himself that she was clean, that she'd showered just before leaving her apartment, that her

workout clothes were all freshly laundered. He was doing okay. It wasn't long at all before he could detect her perfume in the air--a distinct sweetness in the air. He caught his breath--but the usual nausea didn't come. As he watched her, he told himself she was clean, that even if she was working up a sweat right now, she had started out clean, so how could she make him ill?

He tried to imagine it was Effie he was watching working out. Now, as he watched the woman move, the lines, the curves of her body flexing under the thin film of body-hugging lycra, he even felt the warmth of sexual arousal. He wasn't disgusted by the presence of another person working out so close to him, he was turned on. Though it wasn't Effie, he tried to embrace that feeling, to use it to hold off any thoughts of bugs or microbes or rampant bacteria.

'Hey, how's it going?'

Her voice startled him out of his daze. The blonde had noticed him watching her--he'd stupidly failed to notice that the whole wall in front of her was one gigantic mirror. But now as she continued to work out on the elliptical, she turned to smile at him. Jens blushed, but smiled back at her to try to hide his embarrassment at being caught staring. 'Good,' he replied to her. 'You?'

'Never better,' she grinned. The way she moved on the machine, the way she smiled--she seemed to invite him to continue staring at her, to continue checking her out. Jens was a little surprised, he got the sense that perhaps if he'd been a single man, this woman might not object to him talking with her, flirting with her.

Did people just connect like this? So easily?

But now Jens made a show of glancing at his watch, as though he'd run out of time, like his schedule was packed. The blonde gave him a last smile as he picked himself up from the rowing machine, dabbed at the sweat on his brow with his small towel. He even managed to return her smile, and then he walked out of there, head held high.

Maybe he really was making progress.

TURNED ON

He did fall asleep. But then the text message came through announcing that, finally, she was on her way home.

(Effie): Are you awake, honey? I'm on my way home. Should I take a swim before I come back to the apartment? I did shower at his place.

He had been sitting on the sofa, watching Netflix, when he had eventually succumbed to his fatigue. But now, his phone buzzed with the sound of her text message, and he was suddenly awake again, alert.

She had showered at his place.

So, she'd done it, then? She'd had sex with him? Jens shivered as a wave of sexual arousal swept through him. He texted her back:

(Jens): Hey, sweetie. No, you don't have to take a swim--I'm awake. Can't wait to see you again! Did you have fun?

(Effie): A lot of fun... can't wait to tell you everything xx

He was nervous, more nervous than ever, now that she was on her way home. As he waited for her, he wondered where he wanted her to find him--in bed, as though he'd been calmly sleeping, or out here on the couch where it would be more obvious that he'd waited up for her anxiously. He also thought about Effie, and how she would be when she returned--had she had sex? Would he see her and be utterly repulsed by her?

He was afraid that when she did get back, he would be unable to cope with the reality of what had happened. Or, he would find himself getting ill, knowing how dirty she was, even after a shower at his place. Sure, he had this strange sexual arousal right now, thinking about some other man putting his hands all over her, making her squirm, making her come. But what if all that changed when she got back?

He paced around the apartment. He sat in different places. He tried to watch the TV. His pulse was elevated, the butterflies were fluttering around his stomach--and worst of all, he felt the sweat beading up across his brow.

'You can do this, you can do this,' he told himself, the sound of his voice in the empty apartment seeming odd.

But he swept the sweat from his brow with a couple of fingers, and winced at how gross he was. He felt the anxiety well up, he felt the mild nausea, he couldn't just stand around like this.

He took another shower, scrubbed and scrubbed and scrubbed until his skin felt raw. When he came out, he was really worried he'd react badly to Effie coming back. Dry, with only a towel wrapped around his middle, he went to sit on his bed, on the far side of the mattress from the bathroom and the bedroom doors. He would try not to react to her, try to conceal any distaste. He desperately wanted to avoid offending her--and even if she did know so much about his condition, she might still be offended by his response to her. He wanted to avoid putting her off this new adventure she was embarking on.

'Hey, sweetie!'

And here she was.

His heart thumped in his chest. For now, his cock remained rock hard.

'In here, honey!'

She hung up her coat out by the front door, and then there she was, stepping into the bedroom doorway wearing that little black dress, her black stockings. Looking so gorgeous.

'Hey,' she smiled at him, and he smiled back, a sense of pure joy blooming inside him as he experienced powerful lust on seeing her, rather than any kind of anxiety or nausea.

She looked so delicious. He couldn't believe how much he wanted to just tear that dress off her, touch her, stroke his face up against all that wonderful smooth, caramel skin, to breathe her in, maybe even attempt a kiss...

'Everything okay?' she said.

'Oh, uh... yeah,' he said, seeing that she was curious about the fact that he was only wearing a towel. 'I just took another shower,' he said, and then worried that she might take that to mean he'd spent all evening in the shower because of his OCD, he added: 'I used the gym, so...'

She nodded. God, he could see a slight sheen of perspiration on her forehead, and perhaps on her upper chest just above where the plunging

neckline of her dress exposed her cleavage--and he still just wanted to touch her, to consume her. How crazy it was that he'd been so upset by his own sweat that he'd needed another shower--and here he was, gazing at a woman who had just come from outside, from a ride in a taxi, from a night with another man, and all he wanted to do was lie with her and experience her.

'Well I guess I should take another quick shower myself,' she grinned. 'It's so hot and humid out there tonight, you know? Not like Denmark at all. Thank God for air-conditioning, that's all I can say...'

For a moment he just watched her, noticing her stiff nipples pushing through her dress. Was she even wearing her bra anymore?

Then he said, 'Don't.'

Her brow creased in puzzlement. 'Don't?'

He took a deep breath. 'Don't shower. Not yet.'

Slightly confused and self-conscious, she toyed with the straps of her dress. 'Everything... okay?' she said again, and the anxiety on her face made him realize she was worried he had changed his mind about her dating Nicolai, that he might have a problem with her.

'Everything's fine,' he said calmly, his voice warm and reassuring. 'I just want to... look at you. That's all.'

She smiled a touch bashfully, but looked clearly somewhat relieved. She gave a coy little pose, and turned around so he could see her back, as though she was modeling her clothes for him. 'I don't mind you looking,' she said. 'You don't want me to take a shower first?'

His eyes connected with hers. 'No. Not yet.'

He could smell the shampoo she'd used in the shower at her lover's apartment. No scent-free toiletries there, yet. Another reason she'd offered to take a swim--or a shower--even after cleaning up at his place before coming back here. It didn't freak him out, though to his sensitive nose, the floral scent of the shampoo did seem so basic and so overdone. It was like comparing the music from a live string quartet to some awful elevator music.

And yet, the mere fact that she smelled of shampoo triggered excitement in him. It was proof she'd showered somewhere else, that she'd had reason to shower. It was evidence that she had been naughty with another man.

Jens said, 'Lift up your dress. Slowly. Let me see.'

Her smile flickered again, and then tentatively, because she wasn't quite sure what he wanted from her, she lowered her hands to the hem of her dress, then tugged it upward. He caught his breath as she revealed the

tops of her stockings, the bare flesh of her upper thighs and then the pure thrill of her semi-sheer black lace panties.

'Did you enjoy your date?' he asked her.

'Yes, I did,' she said, and he could see she was warming to this, she was beginning to enjoy him cautiously exploring his sexual attraction to her.

'Did you... sleep with him?'

She toyed with the waistband of her panties, tilting her hips slightly, this way and that, pleased at how he responded to her. He removed his hands from his lap, and there almost seemed to be sparklers in her dark eyes as she laid her eyes on the bulge in his towel.

'There was no sleeping,' she joked, with a sly little grin.

'Did you have sex, then?'

'Depends what your definition of sex is.'

She raised her dress a little higher, to give him a glimpse of her midriff, her navel. But his focus was on her panties. Her lover must have seen her like this, must have seen her sexy lingerie. Had he peeled them off? Left them on her? God, how he wanted to bury his face between her legs. How could he have such an urge? Just days or weeks ago, such a thought would have made him ill. Now, it made him hard.

'Take your dress off,' he said, his tone polite, even if his words were an order.

'As my master pleases,' she smiled, but complied, slipping the straps of her dress over her shoulders, allowing it to fall down to expose her bare breasts, those wonderfully erect nipples. Then it slipped down past her stomach, to her hips.

'Where is your bra?' he asked her.

'In my bag,' she said. 'I didn't think I'd need it when I got back here. I thought I'd be straight in the shower. Or the pool.'

She flicked her long, dark hair over her shoulders, as though to make sure he could take in the sight of her breasts in their full glory. She seemed to enjoy having his eyes roaming freely all over her body. She bit her bottom lip, and Jens wondered if it was some kind of sexual signal, it seemed faintly erotic.

'He took you back to his place after your dinner?' he asked her.

'He did,' she said, wriggling her hips as she pushed the dress the rest of the way over her hips, before allowing it to fall to the floor.

'He saw you like this?'

She took a deep breath, and nodded. 'He did.'

'Take off your panties.'

Slowly, she hooked her thumbs in the waistband of her panties over her hips, and glanced up at him as though to make sure he was ready for this. Then she stooped to peel her underwear slowly down her thighs. She dropped them over her knees and stood upright, allowing the little scrap of black lace to drop to the floor, leaving herself only in her stockings.

Jens ran his eyes all over her, amazed at her beauty, his gaze ultimately falling between her legs, where a tidy little stripe of black fur pointed the way over her mound to her sex.

'So what happened when you got back to his place?'

'We had a glass of wine,' she said, her hands drifting over her bare skin as she stood before him. 'Then I guess we were making out...'

Oh, to be Nicolai. To be entirely confident enough to approach a woman like Effie, to touch her, to taste her. Jens quietly stood up and went to sit on the end of his bed--a few precious meters closer to his near-naked wife. She seemed surprised at his move, but concealed her feelings well. It seemed to Jens that she didn't want to scare him away, she wanted to encourage him, however bold he was willing to be.

'You enjoyed... kissing him?' he asked her.

'Uh-huh,' she said, her eyes feeling him out every moment to see how he was responding to her, and whether she should continue or suggest calling it a night. Once she knew he was still very much on board, she added, 'it was nice. He's a good kisser.'

From here, he could see the goosebumps rising all over her smooth skin, even apparently on her dark nipples. Her scent was stronger, too, that shampoo but also something else, a more earthy scent that he wanted to believe was her arousal beginning to become apparent.

'You were in his bedroom?' he asked.

'Not at first,' she said. 'But it wasn't long until we were there. On his bed.'

He saw her shake a little on her feet--she was tired, she was perhaps a little nervous at what was going on here. She'd had a few drinks during the course of the night, too. He said, 'Why don't you sit? Get comfortable.'

She perched down on the end of her bed, and she really was only a meter or two away now. He was surprised at how close he was to her--at how he was holding it together while he did, and how powerful his attraction was toward her.

'Are you okay?' she asked him, her brow crinkling with concern.

He nodded. 'I think so.'

'I could... I could go take another shower.'

'No,' he shook his head, 'I'm fine.'

He took his hands away from his lap as though to demonstrate that he was fine, just as he'd said, but then his towel fell open, no doubt since it was straining to contain his sizable bulge.

'Wow, well I guess you are,' she said, delighted but trying to maintain her calm, loving how he was responding to her. She leaned back on the bed, lifting one leg so that he could watch every part of her, gifting him a superlative view of everything down to her dark pussy lips.

He could smell her now, he could detect that same spicy scent he'd caught from her underwear before--this was her excitement, this was her sex.

'You tell me whenever you start getting uncomfortable,' she said, her hand slowly gliding over her caramel skin, over her breasts and down her stomach.

'I will,' he said, transfixed.

Somehow she seemed outside the rules, outside his rules for dealing with people. As though she was suddenly immune to triggering his usual unease with other members of the species. Or perhaps, he wondered, his own arousal--his hard cock--simply overrode his usual reactions to his proximity to another person.

All he knew was, he breathed in the air around her, and it only excited him, it only turned him on more.

'Tell me what happened,' he asked her again, and this time she was ready to do as he asked.

'I took off my dress for him,' she said. 'Just like I did for you. And then he was kissing me some more, touching me. His hands all over me...'

Right in front of Jens, Effie was gently stroking herself between her legs. He could hardly believe it, how sexy it was, how pink her pussy was, as she parted her dark lips, how easy it was to see how wet she was already getting--and how thrilled he was to watch her, without a hint of unease.

'He took everything so slow,' she said, 'making sure I was comfortable with all of it, before he went any further. I guess... I hoped he was going to be like that... it took away the fear...'

She gazed at him as she dipped a finger in her pussy, and she was both turned on by his watching and impressed at how he was overcoming his own deep-rooted fears even as she had overcome hers in the company of her new lover, Nicolai.

'We were kissing so deeply--lips, tongues, the whole deal. And he was stroking my breasts and my pussy through my underwear... I was getting so wet for him...'

And now she was getting so wet for Jens, he could see her pussy lips glistening, he could hear the wet sounds as she thrust her finger inside herself, simulating sex.

'...We were just standing by his bed, and I was tearing off his clothes, kissing his chest as I knelt down to remove his pants... and then there was his big cock, right in front of me--'

She looked over to find Jens had his cock in his hand now, and was beginning to stroke it. Seeing him, she was like the cat that got the cream--it was a surprise, she hadn't even thought he was able to do such a thing. Jens was so distracted by her, he hardly even noticed the clammy nature of his own skin, the thin sheen of perspiration over his forehead, and some on his chest. The gentle prickle of heat on the back of his neck. He gripped his hard shaft and slowly pumped it, and it felt good as he watched Effie touching herself. Fucking herself.

'You went down on him?' he asked her.

She nodded. 'He was so patient. It was like I was a teenager again, I was feeling my way, learning everything from scratch. Taking that big thing in my hands... and then in my mouth...'

Jens dropped down onto the floor. He was kneeling right in front of her, his body almost between her legs. It was incredible--he kept waiting for his feelings to turn negative, for his body to revolt against his powerful sexual urges, and yet it wasn't happening. He wasn't getting ill. Every tiny step he made toward her was more thrilling than the last.

He gazed up her beautiful body, seeing her sex in detail, her fingers caressing the delicate folds of her pussy lips, stretching her flesh, stroking circles around her clit. He looked up at how stiff her nipples were, at how bright her smile was across her pretty face.

'You liked it?' he asked her.

She nodded. 'For some of it, I imagined it was you,' she said. 'And some of it... I imagined you were watching, and you enjoyed watching.'

He smiled, and saw her panties lying there on the floor beside him. 'I think I would enjoy watching,' he said, and picked up that little tiny lacy item.

There was no shame now, it seemed. He pressed her panties to his face and breathed in her scent. He felt the dampness in the material, and he didn't care. It was so hot. She'd been wearing these while she'd sucked on another man's hard cock.

She'd been so turned on. Like she was now.

He breathed in her scent from those panties, and looked up at her beautiful eyes, her radiant smile, her beaming adoration, at her approval. He smelled her arousal, and watched as she stroked herself into a powerful climax, her body twitching and shaking and writhing on the bed as her sighs turned into plaintive cries.

He watched her fingers strumming her pussy lips and when she was done, seeming somewhat shocked to have come like that, so close to him, she sat up, giggling, saying how good she felt, asking whether he was really still okay.

'Oh yes,' he smiled, and she leaned down as though forgetting herself, forgetting the boundaries. She leaned down and he knew what she was seeking, and he tilted his head up to meet her lips, pressing his own against hers--only briefly, astounded at how soft and how sweet her lips seemed. A kiss, their first.

And then he felt his cock bucking and bolting and firing off stream after stream of thick cream.

'Oh God, I'm so sorry,' he said, embarrassed and yet somehow so elated.

And she seemed so happy, his early ejaculation hardly took the edge off things at all.

EVE'S ORCHARD

'So am I right in thinking she hasn't... had full intercourse with the other man, yet?' the therapist asked.

Jens shook his head. 'Not yet. They were taking things step by step--they almost went all the way, but not quite yet.'

'Has it changed your own feelings about Effie sleeping with Nicolai--the fact that you've been making so much progress yourself?'

'No, not really. I still want her to date him. I still want her to... sleep with him. I think she'd have fun.'

'And you're still having strong sexual desires for her to see another man besides yourself?'

'Yes, you might say that.'

Monday morning, Effie was up at 6:30 as usual, having her breakfast of cereal and rye bread with mild cheese while watching the morning news, before hopping under the shower. Jens woke--as usual for him--while Effie was taking her shower, but instead of heading out to have his breakfast while Effie dressed and got ready for work, today Jens remained where he was, in bed.

He watched her step out of the bathroom, he watched her drying off.

'Oh--God!' she said as she pulled the towel away from her head, and saw him lying there in bed completely unexpectedly. 'You made me jump!'

'Sorry,' he smiled. 'You want me to go out there?'

She flashed him the brightest of smiles herself as she saw him admiring her naked body as she let the towel slip. 'I don't mind you staying,' she said, giving him a subtle twirl as though she was assessing her rear view in the mirror. 'But don't you think there's a danger you'll get... you know... all hot and bothered?'

He chuckled. 'I think we're way past that stage,' he said, peeling back the bedsheet to reveal his hard cock.

She flashed her eyes as she caught sight of it, but then pouted. 'It's so unfair, I don't have any time to stay and enjoy it.'

'You could be late for once,' he suggested.

She shook her head. 'Not on a Monday.'

'You're such a corporate worker bee,' he laughed, though he knew Effie was getting sufficiently senior at her multinational bank that she could hardly be labeled a 'worker bee' these days.

She laughed herself, 'I should give it all up and join a nice little boutique fragrance house like yours. Maybe I could be a receptionist or something.'

They teased each other about their different jobs, sometimes, but they were both proud of the other. Effie worked so hard, and had risen quickly through the corporate ranks, and done well enough that they could afford to live in a luxury apartment in a nice part of an expensive city. Most of her old university friends had to live miles outside Copenhagen these days. Jens didn't exactly have much room for promotion in his job, there was one 'nose' in a fragrance house, and he was already it. But the fragrances that he was personally responsible for creating were now being sold at the most exclusive stores in Denmark, even at Illum. Effie always saw them when she was shopping along Stroget, the city's walking street, and was always so proud. And one scent was even said to be a favorite of Princess Marie. But neither would have suited working in the other's company.

This morning, however, Jens changed the subject.

He said, 'Will you be seeing him today?'

She said, 'Nicolai?'

He nodded.

'Of course,' she smiled, 'he's working at my company just now. I see him every day.'

She opened the top drawer of her oak chest, and pulled out some underwear. He could see that she was moving more slowly than usual, apparently enjoying having him watch her while she was naked.

'You should wear something nice, then,' he said. 'Maybe you'll get lucky.'

'Get 'lucky'? she laughed. 'You know we don't actually date at the office.'

He smiled. 'Who knows, maybe there'll be time for a quickie in the stationery cupboard.'

She held up a tiny little scrap of pale pink satin, a thong that was so scanty it was almost a g-string. Women really wore that kind of underwear, for real? And when did Effie go out and buy that kind of underwear? She must have been preparing to date Nicolai for some time... it seemed hot to Jens.

'That one,' he said before she could put the pink g-string down again. 'You should wear that.'

She giggled. 'My husband wants me to wear date panties to work,' she said to herself, amused. But she did stoop to put on the tiny pink thong.

'You could take him for a nice secluded lunch somewhere... somewhere where there's a little privacy,' he suggested.

'Down by Christianshavn?' she laughed, referring to the area where her office was located, a neighborhood of old artificial islands separated from the rest of the city center by the Inner Harbor.

'They have stationery cupboards in your office, right?' he said, stroking himself under the bedsheet while he watched her pull her underwear into place, tweaking at the thin waistband.

'You have heard we use computers nowadays?' she grinned, again giving him a subtle twirl, loving his attention.

'Toilets, then, you have to have those.'

She giggled. 'How romantic.'

She added the matching pink satin bra, and from the wardrobe a pink shirt that he wouldn't have said was normal for Effie, either, but seemed cute on her. She took out a black pant suit from the wardrobe, and Jens surprised even himself by how boldly he suggested a skirt, instead.

'My husband wants me to get laid at work,' she said, as though to herself, but she did as he asked and opted for a black skirt that was surprisingly high above the knee.

'Don't you want to have him lusting after you, every moment he lays eyes on you?' Jens grinned.

'I like it better when you do,' she said, walking around to his side of the bed now that she was dressed, to give him a close-up view. It was a risk for her, even though he'd gotten so close to her the night before, but it was a calculated risk. She wanted to challenge him, she wanted to push him a little, to encourage his progress.

He loved every moment of her display, and allowed her to see his response, the bedsheet falling away from his hardness. She genuinely enjoyed seeing that. She was so stunning. He almost reached out to touch her. Instead, he simply watched, and breathed her in.

'You should put some of that perfume on,' he said. 'Eve's Orchard, isn't it?'

She stopped still, her jaw dropping at that. 'How did you know--' she said, then, 'I don't wear it in here. And it's always faded by the time I get home...'

He shrugged. 'It's in your clothes sometimes,' he said. 'It was how I figured out you were dating.'

She went over to the chest of drawers to pick up her bag--and from it, she withdrew a small fragrance bottle--Eve's Orchard. 'Your senses are amazing, you know that?' she said.

'You can put a little on, if you like,' he said.

'Here?'

He nodded.

'But you don't like to smell perfume that's being worn by someone.'

'I like it when it's being worn by you,' he said.

That made her smile again. He so loved making her smile.

'I'll put some on when I get to work,' she said.

'You can put a little on now, if you like.'

Again, she was surprised. 'You're sure about that?'

He shrugged. 'I told you, I like it.'

She gazed over at him, taking in how he watched her, how perfectly attentive he was. 'It's part of your... thing?' she asked him.

'My thing?'

'Your fantasy. Your fetish. I don't know what you call it.'

He smiled. 'It does make me think of you... you know... dating him.'

She smiled, enjoying turning him on after such a long time in which their relationship, their marriage was sterile of these kinds of feelings. Now he watched as she applied a little perfume to her neck underneath her jawline, behind her knees and to her wrists.

When she rubbed her wrists together, Jens said, 'You know, you shouldn't rub perfume.'

'No?'

'If you rub perfume, it overheats and the molecules break down. It won't smell as it should.'

'Oh. Well, you're the expert,' she chuckled.

'You can just let it lie on your skin,' he said, breathing in deeply, the scent of perfume on his wife thrilling him intensely, partly because he now associated it with the fact that she was dating.

She took a step toward him, cautiously, but still he seemed to enjoy her presence. 'You're making so much progress, you know that?' she said.

He stood, and they were directly in front of each other, gazing into each other's eyes. 'You inspire me,' he said quietly, and then he leaned in to plant a delicate little kiss on her closed lips. She was tearing up, he almost thought she was about to cry, but he could tell it was happy tears. It took her a moment or two to pull herself together.

Then she said, almost whispering, 'I wish I didn't have to go right now.'

He smiled. 'Go. Work. Flirt with your handsome lover. Find a nice, safe stationery cupboard...'

She giggled. 'You're incorrigible.'

'I'll see you tonight. Hopefully, a lot of you.'

'Can't wait.'

He lay in her bed after she was gone, breathing her in. God, he was turning into such a degenerate.

IN THE LABORATORY

Work, for Jens, meant a six-story building on Rosenborggade, a street in the middle of the city center, not too far from the Rosenborg Castle Gardens. Named after the founder's wife, Mathilde Laursen, it was still owned by the Laursens after nearly a century of operation. A family business, working there had the feeling of being in a kind of extended family.

While most employees entered the building through the front entrance, Jens was able to drive his little electric car past the row of parked bikes lining the street, and through a large gateway through the building, to the small courtyard at the back. Out of the car, he could access a small door that led directly to the lab, where only he and his assistants were permitted.

Through the door was a washing station, where he and his assistants could maintain their strict hygiene after stepping in from the outside.

He knew how lucky he was to work for a company like this, and yet the company also recognized the talent he had, and the qualifications that supported him--he'd worked hard to get here--studying at the finest establishments in Europe, including the perfumeries of Grasse, on the French Riviera. He carried a fair amount of respect within the firm, even if he generally avoided co-workers who were not actively under the strict cleanliness protocols of the laboratory.

So when he came to his own office within the laboratory, and decided to throw out everything that they had achieved so far on the current work-in-progress, there was a look of mild frustration on the faces of his three assistants--but a general feeling that whatever his reasoning was for doing so, he had to be right.

'What is it, boss?' Lukas said, 'Too much orange blossom, right? I was thinking so only last week... it's too overwhelming...'

But Jens shook his head. 'It's not the orange blossom. Our marketing people have decided on *Faengslende* as the name for this scent, right? *Captivating*. But we've refined it and refined it again, and to me... it's not captivating.'

Katrine said, 'It's a very nice fragrance... I know so many women who would buy this in a second. My friends--'

But Jens shook his head. As much as he respected Katrine's opinions, she was on the far side of her fifties by now--she, and her friends, were not the target market for this scent, though the marketing guys hoped older women might desire this scent because it was being aimed at sophisticates in their thirties or forties.

Jens sighed. Was he being insane? Was his professional nose now being skewed by his awakening desire for his wife?

He paused for a moment, then said, 'A woman is captivating in her own right. We're not here to cover that up, to conceal her behind a smokescreen of flowers and sugar. We should be discovering her, empowering her, celebrating her--not hiding her away behind a sweet barricade.'

'What are you saying?' Katrine asked. Lukas and Maja just looked at him in confused silence.

He sighed again. What did he mean? He could hardly tell them that he was inspired by his wife's potential infidelity. That her dalliance with a new lover had opened his eyes to true female beauty, which made him feel like his whole career up to this point was based on a lie.

'I just think we need to go for something more subtle, more sophisticated--something that draws the attention to our client without stifling her, without trying to project something that she is not. A fragrance that allows her to breathe... and lets the world see who she *really* is.'

God, he could hear himself sounding like one of those idiots in marketing. Talking about a fragrance without really saying anything. Using words just because they sounded good, rather than because they had any meaningful contribution to society.

But what could he say?

He looked down at Katrine, and at Maja, and they each seemed completely taken aback--surprised, delighted at what he had said, though they didn't quite know what to say in reply.

Lukas, however, was still confused. 'I don't get it,' he said. 'A woman doesn't choose a fragrance because she wants people to know what she's really like...'

Katrine and Maja laughed at that, and Katrine gave Lukas a playful slap on the back of the head--only she could get away with that. 'I think it's a wonderful idea,' she said. 'And Lukas knows nothing. Women want to be noticed, but they want to be themselves, they want to be recognized for who they are.'

'They could just put on a little less perfume...' Lukas suggested, before drawing another little gentle slap from his wife.

Jens smiled, and said, 'I'm sorry. All I can say is that I'll know what we're after when I find it...'

The rest of the day was something of a washout in terms of the team's work, but Jens found himself merrily beavering away once he had admitted to himself what he was really doing--making a personal scent, a brand new fragrance geared to one specific woman, Effie.

He worked feverishly, checking through the tiny vials of ingredients to find the ideas to boost his theory. For the most part, he didn't need to smell them to tell which were possibilities, and which would do nothing for his particular muse. No, use of his nose would only come once he had some strong candidates, and once he started working on the design of the overall scent, the structure. Though his nose was sensitive, for the most part perfumery was a craft that resided in his head. He could remember the scent of every ingredient, he could remember how it was to mix this with that. Only as he built a fragrance into something complex, as the ingredients mixed and reacted, and as the balance of the perfume's top, middle and base notes came together, did he need to work with his nose directly.

Normally, it would take days, even weeks to get even an initial concept together for a new perfume. Yet Jens felt driven to prove himself, to show that he wasn't just having some kind of midlife crisis, he wasn't going insane. He worked harder than he'd ever worked before, and by the end of a very long day, he at least had something sketched out--three main ingredients that he believed would form the basis for the new scent. It was very basic, but it was something he could use to show people what he meant. A basis on which they could work.

He called out for Lukas, then for Katrine and Maja, to see what they thought--but they had gone home already. Looking at the clock, he was somewhat surprised to find that it was eight o'clock in the evening already. How the time had flown. It had been a hard day, but an enjoyable one. He had been inspired. He liked thinking about Effie all day while he worked.

But, he had never been this late at work. He felt obligated to text Effie to confirm he would be, unusually, late home from the office--in case she thought something bad might have happened to him to disrupt his routine.

Her reply came quickly:

(Effie): That's good to know--I was starting to get a little worried about you! I'm home, think I'll go take a nice cool swim in the pool. See you soon! xxx

He read her text message and pictured her in his mind, in her swimsuit, moving gracefully through the water. It made him perk up immensely, and motivated him to get out the door as quickly as possible, and into his car for the short journey home.

A CLOSER VIEW

Arriving home, Jens went straight up to the swimming pool. He was pleased that Effie was still up there--he could hear her swimming while he washed his hands in the men's changing room, and then he emerged into the pool area itself, and there she was, gliding through the cool water, so streamlined, so elegant, almost balletic as she moved.

It took a little while before she realized he was there, watching her every move, taking in the beauty of her curves, the movement of her muscles. When she did, she swam up to the side, near where he sat on one of the long benches along the side of the pool. She was all smiles.

'Hey! What are you doing up here?'

'Just waiting for you to finish. Watching you swim.'

She almost seemed to blush, her smile turning coy. 'You seem to like watching me a lot, recently.'

He laughed. 'You might say I've had my eyes opened.'

'By my dating?'

'I guess so.'

'So if I stopped dating now... would you lose interest in me?'

He looked down at her, his manhood stirring as he laid eyes all over her body squeezed in that tight one-piece swimsuit. How could he possibly lose interest in her now? 'I don't think anything could happen that would make me lose interest in you now,' he said.

She smiled again. 'But you don't want me to stop dating, do you? It excites you more than anything.'

He gave a little nod. 'Your sexuality excites me,' he said.

'It could do that, just between the two of us,' she pointed out.

He smiled. 'But why limit it to just you and me?'

She grinned up at him. He could tell it excited her too, the prospect of dating other men. Whether it be Nicolai, or some other lover in the future. She wanted, desperately, to be able to make love to her husband. But the thrill of dating someone new was also now in the mix, and she couldn't close the door on that, if given the choice.

After a pause, she pulled herself up out of the pool, the water rushing off her body as she climbed out, and stood before him, her magnificent body just inches away from him.

'Would you like a closer view?' she asked him, looking down at him now with another beaming smile.

'I would,' he smiled up at her, and ran his eyes all over her. She took his breath away, standing so close he could see the individual stitches around the edge of her swimsuit, as she toweled herself dry.

She seemed to track his eyes around her body, and tugged on the edges of her suit here and there, as though to offer him just a little more flesh to see.

'Come downstairs with me, and I'll take it off for you,' she said.

'Please,' he replied, serious.

She stepped away toward the changing room, and beckoned him along with her with a single finger. But when he went with her, they went straight through the women's changing room without stopping.

'You're not going to take your clothes?'

She grinned. 'I'll come back for them.'

It seemed odd, that she would walk around the apartment building in her swimsuit. Sexy, though, somehow. They found the elevator and pressed the call button, and he was hoping that another guy would pass by, and perhaps lay eyes on her. He was proud of her, but there was some small sexual thrill in the thought of other men desiring her, and yet she was married to him--he would get to see her when she took off that swimsuit. The hallways outside the pool, and outside their apartment, were empty, however.

When they arrived back at their apartment, Effie let go of his hand--and he realized she had been holding it ever since they had left the pool area. Wow. He'd been distracted by the sight of her in that suit, of course, and the hope that she might be seen by someone else. But it hadn't been such a big deal, had it, holding her hand? It felt kind of nice.

Inside, Effie closed the front door firmly behind them and waited a few moments until Jens walked over toward the couch to sit down and collect his thoughts.

Then she took a couple of steps toward him and said, 'So, you want to see this?'

'Oh, uh... sure...' he said, feeling awkward sitting there on the couch, embarrassed that such a stunning creature was standing right there a few meters away in just a bathing suit, and he didn't really know how to behave, what to say, how to sit, where to put his hands.

'Are you okay?' she asked, concerned.

'Yeah,' he tried a smile, and then he tried being honest. 'I... uh... don't know what to do...'

Well, if he couldn't be honest with Effie, who could he be honest with?

She rewarded him with the sweetest smile, and took another couple of steps toward him. 'I know how you feel,' she said, 'it's how I feel when I'm on a date with Nico.'

'Oh, it is?' he shifted on his seat, feeling his erection subside a little. He hadn't thought through quite how nervous she probably was going out on a date with someone she didn't know all that well.

She grinned, 'When he started showing an interest in me... I was terrified.'

'Yeah?'

'At work, sometimes I used to hide in the bathroom if I saw him coming.'

'But you didn't have to... I mean, just because he was interested in you, doesn't mean you had to...'

Effie shook her head. 'I was terrified... but it was a real thrill, finding out he wanted me,' for a moment, she realized what she was saying, and stopped, worried she might be making her husband jealous. But she glanced down at Jens, and he seemed to be relaxing a little more, enjoying hearing about her and Nicolai.

She took another step toward her husband. 'In the back of my mind, I knew that I was allowed to respond to this guy's interest if I wanted to... that my husband was okay with me seeing other guys, even if I hadn't ever done anything about it before...'

Standing in front of him, she was moving her body gently, almost as though slowly dancing to some unheard music. Jens was just stunned by her, breathless, feeling as though he was invading her privacy just by looking at her--and yet she was encouraging him, slowly turning on the spot to let him check out her body all the way around.

'In the end,' she said, 'I was getting so worked up whenever I saw him... so turned on by the possibilities... I had to just face my fear and,

you know, start talking to him...'

He could smell the chlorine on her, and it did seem reassuring to him, clean. And yet somehow, he wanted more, he wanted to live more dangerously, he wanted Effie to just be Effie, not a woman who felt obligated to swim or to shower just to spend time with her husband.

'Why don't you take off your clothes?' she said quietly, and he almost missed her suggestion.

She was looking down, seeing the bulge in his pants, and she wanted to see more--this wasn't a one-way experience, Effie wanted to take pleasure from the gradual opening up of their sexual connection, as well.

'Uh... sure,' he said, trying to pretend to be bolder than he was. Trying to stifle his fears, his awkward self-consciousness, his own personal embarrassment at being so inexperienced, so unprepared.

He pulled himself up to his feet, getting so close to her as he did so that he almost touched her body with his face as he stood. She took a step back, gave him space and a reassuring smile as he fumbled with his clothes, and managed to strip them off leaving himself in just a pair of boxer shorts.

'Those too,' she grinned, pointing at his underwear.

'Oh... uh...' He hadn't had a shower after work, or anything. What if she thought he was dirty, disgusting? But in the scheme of things, it suddenly felt more embarrassing to him to decline Effie's request than to do as she asked. He tugged his boxer shorts down, stretching the material over his large erection and then down his thighs to join the pile of clothing on the floor.

'Sit,' she said, calm, confident, taking control.

He did so, feeling mildly stupid at his nakedness in front of her, trying not to think about the hygiene issues of sitting there on the couch, his bare butt touching the black leather. He felt so vulnerable, a little embarrassed--and yet the way she looked at him, lusting after his hardness, rather than laughing at it, reassured him.

'Now, take hold of it in your hand,' she said, and he didn't have to ask what she meant.

She slipped one of the straps of her swimsuit off her shoulder and then turned away from him, as though to hide herself as she took down the other strap, and slowly peeled her swimsuit down to her waist. Then she turned back toward him, her hands covering her breasts... and then not covering her breasts. She was so beautiful, and for a moment he couldn't tear his eyes away from those dark, stiff nipples.

'That's it,' she said, dancing silently for him, brushing her hair back over her shoulders, stroking her own body, rubbing her hands over her breasts. 'Touch it, baby. Stroke it.'

Now she tucked her thumbs into her swimsuit and pulled it further, down over her hips. She bent down to drag it down her thighs, and when she stood to step out of it, she just about blew his mind.

'You like?' she smiled, so sweetly.

'You...,' he said, and she could see what he was looking at.

'I thought it would be easier on you if I just... shaved it,' she said. 'Do you like it like that?'

She looked like a model, particularly so because in this age of the Internet, of free and easy pornography, the models all had shaven pussies from what he'd seen.

'I like it,' he said, then he found himself wondering what her date might think.

She danced for him, and enjoyed his attention, telling him now and again to keep stroking his cock, as though she needed to. To squeeze it, to pump it. She told him how much she wished she could take it inside her, in her mouth, in her pussy. All the while, she was displaying herself for him--stretching, bending, gyrating to the pulse of unheard music. After a while, he began to detect a slight sheen on her skin as she began to perspire, he could smell something more than just the chlorine on her body--she was getting aroused. And he was turned on by her more and more.

'Can I touch it?' she asked him

'Yes,' he said, suddenly aware of the sweat that was now arising on his own body.

She knelt between his legs and reached for his shaft, smiling prettily as though he'd just given her a bunch of freshly-picked flowers. He caught his breath as her fingers closed around his girth, startled by the contact, and in such a sensitive, private place. Though it was his wife, it was still somewhat shocking for him, his nakedness before her, completely unconcealed, his bare cock so close to her, seen by her, touched by her.

Was he embarrassed? That was certainly part of it. But she seemed so content to hold that thing in her hands, to squeeze it in her fingers, to gently stroke it, to cautiously pump its length. She seemed so happy, he came to accept her doing it--helped by the realization that she wasn't reacting to the contact the way he had, she wasn't disturbed by the

prospect of being so close to another person, a naked person, a naked man, a potential source of dirt and disease.

It felt nice, physically. But what aroused him more was the excitement on her face, the strange joy that it gave her for him to allow her to touch it. It aroused him, and it made his erection harder in her hands, so that she glanced up and giggled, saying, 'You do like it,' with mild surprise and undoubted pride.

Her grip around him tightened a little more as she progressed, and her gaze shifted from his member up to his face as she monitored how he was responding to her touch. But she seemed so enthralled with it that, at last, he began to relax and let go, and even enjoy her touch.

So this was how it was.

After a while, he even started feeling a little foolish that he'd never allowed her to try this before, earlier in their marriage, perhaps even while they'd dated. All he had to do was focus on ignoring his fears about the hygiene thing. Have her do it fresh from the pool, or fresh from a shower. At the same time, he knew full well in the back of his mind that he would not have handled this five years before. He was different now. He had made progress.

'Can I... use my mouth?' she suddenly said, so quietly he almost missed it.

He stifled a gasp, although only just, for fear of offending her. God. She really wanted to put her mouth there? But this was his penis... this was what he used to pee...

Nevertheless the peer pressure felt insurmountable. Here was that classic introvert's dilemma of not wanting to seem like a dick, and yet at the same time being uncomfortable with what was being asked of him. Perhaps before, when he'd been a different Jens, he'd have opted for saying no to her, risking offense and risking embarrassment by telling her he was still uncomfortable with such a notion.

But he'd taken so many risks recently. And he could just go straight into the shower if things turned out badly, the two of them were here in private.

'Uh... okay...' he said, feeling as though he was about to take a step off the highest diving board at an Olympic pool.

She smiled again, so brightly, and he so loved making her happy like that, it gave him additional resolve. He lay back, tried to relax, and then with the base of his shaft firmly gripped in her hand, she ducked down to gently kiss the tip of his cock--and then envelope it in her warm, pillow-soft lips, and in her hot mouth.

'Oh God...' he said, trying not to jump out of his skin.

Oh Jesus, it was so wrong. She had his cock in her mouth, her shapely lips wrapped around his girth, her pretty face sinking down on his length, taking him deep into her throat. How could she do that?

And yet it felt incredible. And recently, things that seemed on the surface to be so very wrong had also started to seem very exciting to him.

She withdrew, but her hand remained in place, slowly pumping him. She looked up at him, smiling so sweetly, so delighted to be doing this, he couldn't feel bad.

'It's not so bad, huh?' she giggled, and he had to return her smile.

'You really... you're okay...?' he said, so doubtful, finding it so difficult that someone would enjoy doing such a thing to a man.

She chuckled. 'I love making you feel good. It makes me feel good...'

He could understand something of that. The excitement that he experienced to know she was being satisfied--even by someone else. Perhaps there was something like that in what she felt going down on him. Sex wasn't just about making yourself feel good, after all, there was a strong element of altruism involved--he'd read enough about it to know that. And if you went a little further down the altruism route, you would get to the kind of feelings he had thinking about Effie dating another man.

She planted little kisses along his shaft, and on his tip, and gently swirled her tongue around his glans as though it was a sweet lollipop.

But then she took him back inside her mouth, sinking down deep on his length, surprisingly deep, and it felt so incredible he knew he was never going to last much longer.

When it happened, he was momentarily gripped by panic, and tapped her on the back of her head to warn her what was about to occur. She looked up at him with confusion at first, and perhaps a little disappointment since she thought he was telling her to stop because he could no longer stand any of this. But it only took a couple of seconds of gazing into his frantic face for her to realize what was going on--and then she suddenly seemed to relax.

She pulled back from his cock briefly, gasping for breath as she continued pumping his shaft with her hand, saying breathlessly, 'it's okay. I want you to, honey. Come for me. Come in my mouth.'

Then she sank down deep on him again, and though he could not understand why she would tolerate such a thing, he was also too far gone to stop himself reacting to her hot mouth, and too overwhelmed by a

myriad of new feelings to really stop and consider how unsavory it might be to have a man shoot his semen into her mouth.

And then he had his hands upon her head, and he was grunting as his hips bucked, and his cock jumped, and his orgasm tore through, and there was nothing he could do to prevent himself from spurting out his thick cream deep into her throat.

As he came, she swallowed, and still seemed completely elated, and Jens even felt a tickle of wrongness about it that only fed back into his own sexual arousal.

How could he be so turned on by something that seemed so wrong? He didn't know, but he couldn't deny his feelings.

COMFORTABLE

'You had intercourse with her, after that?' the therapist asked, as though he was merely asking whether there'd been a cheese course at the end of some fancy meal he'd had.

'No, I didn't. We showered, and then... went to bed.'

'She was happy with that?'

'Seemed to be.'

The therapist gave a little nod.

'This was the second time she'd touched you in a sexual manner.'

'That's right.'

'And you... enjoyed it?'

The man peered at Jens over his spectacles and it seemed like he had more than just professional interest, but was trying to hide his fascination.

'It felt good,' Jens said, and though this should have been a private matter between a man and his wife, Jens felt strangely thrilled about underlining his wife's abilities in this area to a man he barely knew. 'Actually, it was better than good, it was pretty fucking amazing.'

'You didn't have any panic attacks... there was no nausea?'

Jens shook his head. 'I was embarrassed at first. I hadn't had a shower, I was a little... sweaty. But she seemed so interested, so into it, it was reassuring.'

'And she was... naked. You were all right with that?'

'She looked just unbelievable. Kneeling down there. Her breasts...'

'Would you say you were getting comfortable with her touching you?'

'Very comfortable, I'd say.'

'Did she touch any other part of you?'

'She... brushed against my legs at times...'

'And it was okay?'

'It didn't seem to bother her, so --'

'But did it bother you? Were you more worried about how she perceived contact with you than how it was for you?'

He shrugged, 'I was concerned that I hadn't showered--'

'But she didn't worry about it?'

'Not so much, no. I think she was distracted...'

'So do you think you would be able to touch her now?'

'I'm not sure.'

All day at work, every day that week, he thought of her. As he carefully considered ingredients for the new scent, he had her in mind. As he found possible candidates, and confirmed how they worked together, he used her as his target market, his muse.

PREPARING FOR HIM

She'd been shopping, along the walking street, Stroget, and in the early evening had brought back a disturbing number of bags featuring luxurious fashion brands that made the eyes pop--Prada, Gucci, Luis Vuitton, Top Shop, Tommy Hilfiger, Victoria's Secret. Dresses, shoes, lingerie.

His stunned reaction had made her laugh after dropping her bags inside the front door.

'I'm not keeping all of it,' she said.

'You're not?'

'I'll try them on, and take back the ones I don't like.'

'You'll take them back? After trying them on?'

He couldn't quite comprehend the concept, but stopped himself from saying anything further in case she started thinking he was an idiot.

'That's what people do nowadays,' she said, pulling a pair of black high-heeled shoes out of a Gucci bag to admire them, as though she'd forgotten what they looked like. 'You just never paid any attention to it before. And since we always buy you exactly the same clothes each time...'

He really hadn't paid any attention to her clothes shopping before. She went out and shopped, and he always stayed home. When he needed something, it could be easily delivered, and arrived suitably sealed in a plastic bag, unopened, untried.

'But shops really let you just... take something back? After you've worn it?' he asked her.

'Yeah--well, after trying it on. It's hardly like I've worn it more than a minute or two. And I suppose the shop will... well, wash it, before they put it back out for sale.' She shrugged like she had no idea what happened to clothes taken back by customers, and as though even if the

items weren't washed before being put back out for sale, it wasn't a big deal.

Did normal people really care that little for hygiene?

And yet now Effie was looking in a Victoria's Secret bag at something that looked scandalously lacy, and Jens suddenly found that he wasn't interested in whether stores washed clothes returned as unwanted by shoppers. It suddenly struck him that Effie's shopping was all about making herself look sexy for her date that evening.

It reminded him that she was going to sleep with Nico that very night.

'You can watch me try on a few things, if you like?' she said, newly confident in her desirability, in the knowledge that she could turn him on by flaunting herself before him, rather than hiding herself away.

'Uh... okay.'

'Tell me what you think?'

They went into the bedroom, and the way Effie looked in the skin-tight white skirt and crimson long-sleeved top she'd been shopping in, Jens wondered why she even needed to buy new clothes to impress her date. But it was strangely hot, witnessing the lengths to which she was going to impress him. To get him hot for her. To get him ready to sleep with her.

She stood in front of the full-length mirror, but then was turning to face him as she peeled off her crimson top, unzipped her skirt and wriggled out of it.

'You know you don't need to buy anything special to impress him, right?' he said to her, and made her smile.

'But it's all part of the fun,' she giggled, turning slowly to flaunt her body for him, even before she'd put anything new on, even before she'd removed her 'ordinary' black bra and thong set that would make any red-blooded male, and many red-blooded females, quake in their boots just to watch her.

And boy, was it part of the fun. Off came her bra, and then down came her thong, and then she was scampering into the bathroom for a shower, leaving the door open so that he could watch.

'Do the stores require you to shower before you try on their stuff?' he asked her as she washed herself.

'Not at all,' she giggled. 'This is just for your benefit.'

'So most people... don't shower before trying stuff on?'

She looked at his repulsed face and only laughed, and made him once again wonder how ordinary people got through life without being

constantly ill, catching diseases while trying on clothes other people had already tried on, and from cramming into busy streets like Stroget to take unwanted items back.

He noticed how she had left her dirty clothes on the floor in front of the mirror, and it again made him think how different things were getting--before, she would have put her clothes straight in the washing machine, and if she hadn't, he probably would have reacted with shock and horror. And now, here he was feeling bizarrely turned on by the sight of her thong lying there on the carpet, and here he was, waiting until Effie was facing away from him in the shower, then going to pick up her underwear, to marvel at how it was still warm from her body. To cautiously press it to his nose almost like it was some kind of test for how far he had progressed in coming to terms with human proximity.

It was too strong. Though it turned him on to a ridiculous extent, the powerful aroma of her body and her excitement felt as though it was burning his olfactory senses.

'I have clean ones, if you'd prefer.'

Her voice shook him out of his daze, and now he was massively embarrassed to find her standing there wrapped in a towel, looming over him as he knelt on the floor, her panties in his hands.

'No, I...' he said, stumbling over his words, not really knowing what to say, feeling a flush in his cheeks, the fear of what she would think about him.

She took the thong from him, and didn't seem at all angry. But he just wanted the ground to come swallow him up.

'It's okay, you know. It's normal for a guy to... you know... enjoy how a woman smells...'

He gave a little nod, but was so embarrassed he almost felt like throwing up.

Effie smiled, taking pity on him and yet at the same time, somehow pleasantly surprised at what she had caught him doing. 'You really... like this?' she said softly. 'I mean... I never thought... with your sensitive nose...' She put the scrap of black material to her face as he had, but then pulled it away, wrinkling her nose. 'Ooo. I guess I got a little sweaty running around the shops,' she said.

He hated feeling so weak. With his condition, he got to feel that way a lot. But he didn't like it when he was with Effie--the whole point of their relationship, as it had first developed, was that they had both understood where the other was coming from, and that neither of them were being weak in dealing with their issues. Quite the opposite.

So he took a deep breath, and said, 'I'm not afraid of you anymore.'

Anyone else probably would have made fun of him for ever being afraid of a fairly petite woman like Effie. Anyone else might have been surprised he was ever afraid of her. But Effie just smiled, and stroked his hair. 'I'm so proud of you,' she said.

He looked up at her like some loyal, adoring puppy, and said, 'When I discovered... you know... you were starting to get interested in... well, another guy... I guess it opened my eyes.'

She smiled, but sitting on the edge of her bed, she raised a curious eyebrow. 'How did you figure it out? I mean, I knew we'd talked about it a while ago, and that you wanted me to see other guys... but you said you didn't want to know... and I thought I was being subtle...'

He said, 'When our washing machine broke...'

Her eyes widened. 'You could tell from my clothes?'

He shrugged, 'I could smell the perfume you used when you went out...'

She sighed, nodded, 'Not exactly easy to hide that when you can't do your laundry...' then her face brightened up and she added, 'So that turned you on? The perfume?'

He tilted his head thoughtfully. 'Not so much the perfume. You. And when you came back from a night out... there was something...'

'Something in my underwear?' she grinned, and he blushed again. 'I guess it did turn me on, thinking about dating again.'

She held her panties up to her nose again, briefly. 'You really can tell, huh. I guess I was feeling pretty hot about shopping for my date, too.' To his surprise, she handed him her underwear. 'You really like that?'

Jens shrugged. 'It made me think of you... maybe seeing another guy...' He clutched her panties, but still felt a little idiotic about it.

She said, 'You never thought you might want to... you know...' She opened her towel a little, exposing all of her slender legs, her shapely, caramel thighs.

'I was afraid,' he admitted.

'And now?' she gave him a mischievous grin, and hiked the towel another few inches, while parting her knees so he could see her sweet pussy in all its glory.

'Now I have new medication,' he chuckled.

'Viagra?'

'Not quite,' he said, feeling his heart fluttering, feeling kind of dazzled by her pussy being right there in front of him, so close, and the

way that she was leaning back, propping herself up on her elbows, spreading her thighs, inviting him in, offering him the chance to explore.

'You don't have to rush into anything, you know,' she said. 'You don't have to do anything before you're ready.'

'I know,' he said, ducking down to kiss her just inside her knee. He put his hands on her hips, just amazed at how good it felt to touch her body, just stunned at how every inch of her form seemed perfectly designed to turn him on.

Her skin was still clammy from her shower, and he could smell the scent-free soap products she used, even if they were supposed to be just that, scent-free. But as he kissed his way along her thighs, he began to smell her smell--her unique Effie-scent--and also the early signs of her sexual arousal.

God, was she really letting him get this close? Did women really allow men in such an intimate place like this?

He remembered how she had told him about Nico going down on her--and that only boosted his desire for her.

'You're so beautiful,' he said, savoring the sensation of his lips brushing against the soft skin of her inner thighs. 'I can't believe how lucky I am.'

She said nothing for a moment, taken aback by his devotion, by his clear infatuation. She just stroked his hair, and he leaned in to place his lips on her soft skin at the top of her thighs, just inches away from her bare sex. He moved, and planted a little kiss at the apex of her pussy, provoking a little shiver in her. He breathed in her sexy scent, and he dipped his tongue in her moistened groove--and now he was tasting her wetness, and it seemed absolutely incredible to him.

But then she stopped him. 'You're going to get me all horny before my date even begins,' she warned him. 'But afterward... when I get back... we'll have all night...'

He smiled up at her.

'You can take as long as you like,' she said.

He thought about how it might be to be this close to her after she'd been well and truly fucked by her lover. Would he be able to stand it? It excited him to think of it, but he wondered if it would be like flying too close to the sun. He'd get so high, and then if he got too close, he might fall.

He moved back to the bed, let her dry off and start trying on her new clothes, his whole body quivering with sexual energy as he watched her pulling on this dress or that, slipping on underwear that was lacy or satin

or sheer, stepping into shoes with killer heels. He gave her his verdict, then enjoyed her stripping off again, noticing how hard her nipples were, and that despite her shower, and the fact that she'd stopped him from venturing too close to her, she was clearly getting a little wet down there.

He enjoyed deciding on her outfit, her lingerie, her shoes--imagining the reaction of her lover when he peeled her clothes off. Watching her preening her hair, spending extra effort on her makeup, all for the benefit of another man.

And the piece de resistance was the proto-perfume that he offered her, the beginnings of a brand new luxury fragrance that would be entirely inspired by her--all for her to try out on her date. She was lost for words as he gave her the little vial, as he explained himself, as he was finally able to share with her a little more about how he felt about her, about how he was coming to terms with being turned on by her body, her own scent, her sexuality, in a way that bypassed his obsessive-compulsive issues, his hypersensitivity, his abject fear of human contact.

She applied the perfume--sparingly, knowing that though he was making progress, his senses were still acute. And then even with her makeup on, her lipstick on, she leaned into him and kissed him deeply.

God, he'd never been so thrilled. It was just a kiss, though a powerful one. And yet it seemed to draw out every ounce of excitement in him, made him harder than he'd ever been before.

'I'm going to have to go,' she said, after their kiss had seemed to go on for an age and a day. 'I think my Uber's waiting.'

She left, blowing a kiss as the front door closed between them.

BOUNDARIES CROSSED

It was only ten o'clock. Jens had been up to the gym, which seemed like it was becoming part of a routine now, his routine for Effie's date night. The blonde hadn't been there this time, not that it particularly mattered. The gym had been empty, which made him relax and even enjoy the workout. Afterward, he took another shower and felt that perhaps he'd even look to see if there was a new movie to watch on demand.

But stepping out of the bathroom, drying himself off, he heard his phone buzz--which meant a text message had come through. The phone was right on the bed, which meant he could read the message without even touching it, since it had just arrived.

(Effie): I'm so sorry, honey, I don't know what else I can do... or maybe you could go for a swim? Take your book up there and read awhile?

Jens was a little confused, what was she talking about? It was only when he picked up the phone and entered the messaging app that he realized she'd sent other messages earlier, while he'd been in the shower.

(Effie): Hey honey, having a great time! Nico is a lot of fun. Hope you're okay! xx

(Effie): Dinner was nice. I had a couple of glasses of wine, I guess my tolerance is a little low, but I feel more relaxed now.

(Effie): We were in the taxi and I just started kissing Nico, it was so nice. He put his hand on my thigh and I gently moved it up, under my dress, so he was stroking me through my panties while we were making out. It felt so good, so naughty. I love being naughty, knowing how it excites you, honey xxx

Jens felt himself getting hard as he read through her messages, but then he came to the unexpected pivot:

(Effie): Oh, honey, Nico wants me to bring him back to my place--our place. We keep on going back to his place, so it felt kind of unfair to refuse to show him where I live, so I couldn't really refuse him...

(Effie): I think we'll be there in maybe 10 minutes. I can't think of a believable excuse to stop him from coming up... Did you already have your workout at the gym? Maybe you could go for a walk or something, there won't be many people in the park at this time. I'll try and persuade him to go home as quickly as I can...

Jens smiled--he actually felt quietly excited that Effie was bringing Nico back home. That something hot might happen between them, in this very apartment. The old Jens would have been horrified, of course. But the new Jens and his deviant fantasy liked the idea of his beautiful wife being wicked here, in their home, maybe even on one of these beds.

He texted her back:

(Jens): Don't worry, sweetie, you can bring him here if you like. I already had my workout but I could go up to the pool with my book, no problem. You can relax and spend as long as you like with him. xxx

Ten minutes... after pressing the 'send' button, he realized that Effie had sent her text nine minutes previously. There was hardly any time left for him to put on clothes and head out for a walk, or for a swim, or anything.

Then another text message came through, his phone vibrating in his hands:

(Effie): Okay, we're here :-) xxx

His first thought was to tidy up the apartment--but it was already spotless. This was one of the first times ever that he was thankful for having obsessive compulsive disorder. He'd even scraped the door of the shower with the rubber squeegee to get rid of all the water droplets on the glass so that they didn't leave little marks--as he always did after a shower. All he had to do was hang up his towel, and it was as though he had never even been in the apartment.

What would a stranger think, upon coming into this apartment? There was no clutter around, Jens couldn't abide it. Nothing much to make Effie ashamed of where they lived. There were a couple of framed photographs on their bedside tables, but he remembered that Effie had been open with Nico about being married. The only lie had been the suggestion that their marriage wasn't a happy one.

Satisfied with the apartment, Jens put on a pair of boxer shorts--but then, without warning, he heard the scrabbling of a key in the lock on the front door.

They were here already!

Jesus.

He felt pure panic. What would Nico think on discovering a strange man, wearing only a pair of boxer shorts, lurking in Effie's apartment? He dashed into the bedroom, and looked in the bathroom. There seemed nowhere to hide--the shower had glass walls. There were no secret corners in which to conceal himself, no cupboards large enough for a person. In the bedroom, the built-in closets were far too small for a person to hide inside considering how many clothes and accessories were kept inside.

He glanced at the windows. The curtains. They hardly ever used them because he liked to wake up with the natural light of the dawn, and because the apartment overlooked the railway lines, so there was no one who could look in at them. But now, Jens drew the thick fawn-colored material across the floor-to-ceiling windows, and was relieved to find there was plenty of space behind them where he could stand.

He was only just in time--he heard the front door open, and Effie's voice.

'Here we are.'

'Hey, you have a really nice apartment.'

'Well, it's not exactly as palatial as your place, but--'

'I like it. Modern, stylish. Suits you, I guess.'

'Thank you.'

He heard his wife giggle, and then... she was moaning quietly. Jens caught his breath. She was kissing him. The moaning became louder, and he realized that the two of them were in the doorway of the bedroom. He could hear the wet sounds of them tangling their lips together.

'Twin beds, huh?' he heard Nico say.

'I told you, didn't I? My husband likes it better that way.'

'And he's out all night tonight?'

'Uh-huh.'

He could smell Effie's perfume, or at least the mixture of perfume ingredients he had designed for her--it was hardly a finished product. It did suit her, though, and it did have that hint of exhilaration that suggested arousal. So sexy. There was something else in the air, a refined smoky sweetness--cologne. Whatever Nico was wearing was expensive, and thankfully fairly understated. Despite all his progress, and the powerful sexual kink that made him want his wife debauched by a man he didn't know, Jens probably couldn't have remained there, out of sight,

if Effie's date had sloshed Old Spice or something horrific all over himself.

'Comfortable?'

'Very.'

Jens slowly edged himself along to the gap in the curtains, parting the two sides very gradually so that he could see into the bedroom. Nico, wearing a smart white shirt and black pants, his short blonde hair tidy, his face clean-shaven, was sitting on Effie's bed, as though testing it out.

'But I wouldn't care if it was hard as nails,' he joked, gazing up at Effie, who stood in front of him in her pretty white dress, which showed off her cleavage so very well.

'Good,' she said, stepping up to him, brushing her hair back with her hands, which had the added bonus of pushing her chest forward to capture his attention with her breasts. 'So why don't we test it out?'

She lifted the hem of her dress, giving him a quick flash of her thighs, her panties, her flat stomach. Startling him, it seemed at first.

'Wow,' he said, and his response to her beauty had a strange warming effect on Jens himself. It was exciting that another man was so turned on by her, and yet she was his wife.

Effie giggled, enjoying her date's attention, and then pulled her dress higher, and then off over her head. Her underwear was lacy and white, contrasting beautifully against her skin.

'My God,' Nico said, putting his hands on her waist, moving them up to cup her shapely breasts. He stood, his hands remaining on her chest, fondling her as he leaned in to kiss her mouth.

Effie moaned as he slipped one, and then both of her breasts free of her bra, his thumbs grazing over her hard nipples. Nico ducked down, kissing the upper slopes of her breasts, trailing down to take one nipple, and then the other, into his mouth. She stroked his hair as he sucked on her breasts, moaning quietly.

Behind his curtain, Jens was doing everything he could to breathe quietly, to keep his heart from hammering so loudly they could hear him, to keep his hard cock still in his pants as he watched another man pull his wife into a close embrace, kissing her lips with real passion. He'd never been so turned on--Effie looked stunning, and watching her with her new lover, it felt strangely as though he was the man kissing her, touching her, squeezing her breasts. He had allowed this, he had encouraged Effie to find this man. It was as though Jens was her lover by proxy.

Nico stood behind her, which gave Jens a superlative view of Effie as the man cupped and fondled her breasts, squeezing her nipples between

his fingers. Then he turned her, urging her down on the bed, pulling off his shirt quickly as she leaned back, parting her legs for him. He leaned down to kiss her mouth, and then her stomach, and then Effie lifted her hips to help him peel away her panties.

Jens nearly gasped as the man dropped Effie's panties on the floor. The scent of her arousal was a little stronger as her new lover knelt between her legs to kiss his way along her inner thigh.

'Very nice,' he said as he kissed his way toward her sex.

'I thought you'd like it,' Effie said, and Jens had to take a moment to figure out what she meant--she was referring to shaving her pussy, something she'd said she'd done for her husband. Now Jens felt his chest burn with a little jealousy as Effie more than hinted that she'd actually done it for her new lover. Curiously, that little burn of jealousy inside only seemed to enhance the excitement he felt about what was happening to his wife.

With the two of them out there suitably distracted, Jens felt safe to slip his hard cock out of his boxer shorts so that he could stroke it. Nico kissed Effie's sex, and she lay her head back onto the mattress in response, moaning breathily.

Jens could smell her arousal even thicker in the air, even above her perfume and her lover's cologne. It tickled his own desire. Jens envied the man being able to press his face against her soaking pussy, touching her, licking her, sucking on her, tasting her. He envied the man's ability to make her moan like that, to make her sigh and cry out, her hands moving to his head to press his face against her sensitive sex.

'Mmm... it feels so good...' she said, almost purring.

Jens felt the desire inside him superseding his fear of touching her, *he* felt a strong lust for her, he wanted to touch her, to kiss her, to taste her. Was this progress? Or was it merely temporary, his lust pushing him to want things he would ordinarily be too terrified to try?

Her new lover seemed to enjoy eating her, seemed to enjoy the way she tasted. He lapped at her like a cat at the cream, tickling her clit with his tongue, sliding his tongue inside her, feasting on her copious wetness.

'Oh... oh...' her moans seemed like the most beautiful sounds Jens had ever laid ears on. Effie was gently pushing up her hips to meet her lover's mouth as he sucked on her, and as he slid his fingers inside her. Her moans were becoming cries.

Nico looked up at her, and she looked down at him, and they were totally connected, totally bound up in her sexuality, in her excitement.

Jens was so envious of him, getting to experience her this way. He'd never seen his wife like this, in such heaven.

But he didn't make her come, not just yet. She urged him up, and sat up herself, and then Jens watched her unfasten the man's belt, opening his fly, exposing his big, hard cock. Wow. Was this really happening?

'Mmm... give it to me...' Effie purred, and her lover was happy to oblige.

It felt so strange. Another man, virtually naked in his bedroom, with his naked wife. Effie stretched up to kiss Nico on the mouth, and then she lay forward, on her front with her elbows on the edge of the mattress. She curled her fingers around his manhood, and started to stroke it.

Jens felt that slight burn of jealousy again, deep inside. He watched her stroking this other man's cock and it had the unexpected response in him of making him feel that he could do this, she could have this from her husband. And yet the burn, the strange tightness inside his chest that came from fear--fear that he might somehow lose Effie now that she was exposed to this 'normal' man and his lovemaking skills--it all, somehow, fed into the feverish excitement that he felt, hiding there behind the curtain, stroking his own cock, watching as his wife brought the tip of her lover's manhood to her lips.

Jens held his breath. Effie gently touched the end of Nico's cock to her bottom lip. She stroked it with her lip, and then her tongue flicked out to swirl around the very tip of his cock. Now she stretched her lips around him and took the crown inside her mouth. Looking up at him, she bobbed down on his shaft, taking it surprisingly deep. Then she withdrew again, exploring it with her lips and her tongue.

Oh goodness. Beautiful Effie. She had another man's penis in her mouth. It was a shock--and yet, once again Jens felt his libido tickled. The very wrongness of what he was witnessing felt sexy, the very sense of wickedness surrounding this behavior turned him on more and more. Effie was being dirty, so dirty. Cheating on her husband. Sucking on another man's cock. Putting a comparative stranger's prick in her own mouth.

She was moaning quietly as she sucked on him, as though she was enjoying it. Perhaps it was just exciting, being up close to a man in a way she had been unable to experience throughout her marriage. Nico leaned forward, over her, as she bobbed her head down on his cock, so that he could reach her behind, squeeze the pert orbs of her buttocks, and even stroke her pussy. The way he was moving his hips almost made it look as

though he was fucking her mouth, taking control. Effie seemed to love every moment.

When he leaned back, giving her throat a break, she stroked his glistening cock around her pretty face, over her cheeks, her chin, her forehead. It was as though she was marking herself as his territory, painting herself with that enormous thing, making herself his. It made the jealousy within Jens flare up, but also the excitement. He almost felt like bursting out from behind the curtains to knock him away, to reclaim her as his own.

But Jens managed to maintain his calm.

It was made more difficult as he watched Effie withdraw from the man's cock, look up and say, 'I want you to fuck me. Now.'

Jens felt his heart thumping so hard it might just about have cracked his ribs open. This other man was going to fuck her. He was going to fuck her like her husband couldn't. But wasn't that the point of all this? Jens was giving her this experience, Nico was effectively representing him in the fucking of his wife. This wasn't like full adultery where a woman might look for an emotional connection with someone, because her husband couldn't provide one. Jens had a strong emotional connection with Effie. Nico was just about the sex.

That thought dissipated some of the fear Jens felt. It meant he could keep control of those feelings of jealousy, focus on the thrill of watching Effie make way for Nico to lie on the bed.

'You're sure about this?' the man said, and Jens found he liked him more for such an attitude.

'I'm sure,' Effie said, although her husband could tell she was nervous.

Nico lay on his back, making it clear that he wanted her to take control, that he thought Effie would be more comfortable taking the lead, in order to move this as slowly as she needed. She was grateful, climbing onto him, stretching her legs wide to straddle him, moving so her sex was just inches away from that hard rod of iron.

God. God. God.

Jens watched, and although he couldn't see everything from where he was standing, he could see her gorgeous rear hovering over the man's thighs, he could see the man's cock pointing upward, the tip lost between her legs, presumably nudging up against her wet pussy. He could see her hesitate, then reach down to position the man's cock exactly where she wanted it. He could see her getting a feel for having a man's cock touching her most intimate place for the first time in a long time.

He could see her sink down on it slowly, taking it inside her.

Jens gasped, and it escaped his mouth--but the noise came at almost exactly the same time as Effie gasped, feeling herself filled by a hard cock for the first time in so long--the first time since she'd been so traumatized. For a moment or two, she sat up still, holding his cock within her sex, getting used to it. Perhaps she was dealing with a few lingering fears, a few stubborn demons. Jens felt the odd sense of being proud of her, for making so much progress, for trying to get back the life that had been lost to her by one man's evil. Then there was a moment of concern, that this might actually be too much for her--that she was facing trauma again.

But then she started to move, slowly, the muscles in her thighs tightening and releasing as she lifted herself, and sank again, stirring that hard cock within her sex. She stirred, and then she was rocking her body over his, her hands on his shoulders, her breasts gently swaying, her eyes locked on his.

'Oh God...' she moaned, and Jens very nearly came right then and there.

His wife was fucking another man, right in front of him. He could hear the wet sounds of the man's cock moving within her soaking pussy, he could see the slight sheen of perspiration on their skins, he could smell his wife's arousal, much stronger now.

It was almost overwhelming for his senses, particularly his highly-tuned olfactory senses, his professional nose. And yet the sexual thrill was so powerful, Jens did not move from his spot behind the curtains--he held tightly to his own stiff cock and watched as Effie fucked her new lover.

'Oh please... oh please... oh please...' she kept saying, as though it wasn't her in control of this, holding the man down, fucking him increasingly roughly, her hips gyrating, her breasts jiggling, her hair swaying.

They weren't even using condoms, which old Jens would have completely freaked out about, though new Jens felt strangely serene, for some reason liking the awful reality of another man squeezing his bare cock inside Effie's sweet flower.

After a while, he watched as Effie rolled onto the bed and ceded control to her lover, Nico holding himself up between her legs to drive his hard cock back deep inside her, before thrusting into her again and again at his own speed. He watched them kissing, sliding their tongues in each other's mouths, he watched Nico withdraw his cock from Effie's sex

and she took it back into her mouth, even though it was slick from her juices.

He watched the sweat drip from their bodies, their hair becoming damp and then soaked through. He watched as the air became saturated with the musky scent of their sex, and still it didn't sicken him--it made him feel oddly alive.

He watched his wife go on all fours for her lover, who entered her from behind as though they were animals.

He watched as his wife knelt in front of him and pumped his cock in her hands until he sprayed his thick cream all over her body. He watched as she grinned and giggled and rubbed the man's semen into her skin.

He watched as they lay beside each other, panting for breath, and Nico asked her, 'Everything okay?'

And she replied, 'Oh yes. More than 'okay'. That was incredible.'

He watched as they kissed and cuddled, as though they were the ones in this room who were married. And the jealousy flared up again, more so this time, as there wasn't the accompanying sexual thrill to dilute it. And his legs started throbbing from his standing up for so long--he felt close to collapse.

But then Effie was on her feet, and dragging Nico along with her into the bathroom, closing the door behind them as the shower started up, and Jens had a brief opportunity to escape.

DEEP CONNECTION

He was attempting to relax, sprawled out on a sun lounger by the pool, as though he'd been here all along. He had his Kindle on, and was attempting to reacquaint himself with a fairly derivative thriller that attempted to jump on the Gone Girl bandwagon of domestic strife, but with little success. His mind was on other things.

He'd changed into his swim shorts, and had the chilled dampness of the pool water on his skin, but his dip in the shallow end had been purely to cool himself down and rid himself of any bodily evidence of his sexual voyeurism, rather than for exercise or to really pass the time.

All he was really doing was waiting, whether it be for a text from Effie asking him if he'd be so good as to book into a hotel for the night, or as he hoped, instructions for him to return home once her lover had departed. He wasn't reading, and it wasn't as though he was getting any sun--even if this wasn't an indoor pool, even if the sun hadn't gone down a while ago, this was Denmark.

To his surprise, it wasn't a text message that ended his struggles to focus on his Kindle--it was the sound of Effie's voice.

'Well, there you are!'

She stepped out from the women's changing room onto the poolside, wearing her swimsuit, no less.

'Hey,' he said, smiling up at her, feeling the sexual arousal flooding his body once again to lay eyes on her, and in that provocative, high-cut swimsuit of hers.

'Everything okay?'

'Of course,' he grinned. 'Is he... gone?'

Jens felt so light-headed, and his heart was fluttering. This gorgeous creature had just had sex. She was fresh from fucking another man, right down in their own apartment. His stunning wife was so naughty, so sexy,

so ripe, so unbelievably attractive to him, it almost made him want to jump on her, almost held his underlying fear of human contact in check.

'He has,' she smiled coyly, glancing down at her toes as though she'd suddenly noticed her nails needed polishing. Then she seemed to dispel her natural bashfulness, as though remembering this wasn't her father subtly attempting to police her latest date--this was her husband, who was sexually aroused by the thought of her dating. She said, 'I thought I'd have a quick rinse and a swim, and then maybe we could...'

Jens liked the idea of watching her swim, and that the glint in her dark eyes hinted at maybe some kind of mild sex play after she was cleaned up, maybe some kind of striptease on her part, maybe even a little minor touching... but right now, his own sexual arousal won out over his fear.

'Wait,' he said, pulling himself up to his feet.

She took a half-step back, unsure of what he was thinking.

'Don't go anywhere,' he said, and she did freeze where she was, compliant.

'I can just... go shower,' she suggested, 'if you'd prefer. We could just go downstairs...'

He shook his head, and stepped up to her. Oh God. He could smell her, he could smell the sex on her--it was mild, perhaps because it was swamped by the chlorine tang of the swimming pool, but it had an unbelievable effect on him, stiffening his cock, sharpening his senses, boosting his heart rate, stirring his blood. She'd brushed her hair back into a ponytail, and her body was no longer glistening with perspiration, but Effie really had come straight from bedding another man.

'Did you sleep with him?' he asked her quietly. 'Did you... fuck him?'

Her eyes quivered slightly as she looked deep into his, trying to extract his true feelings, trying to assess how he wanted her to answer--to confirm that he really did want her to have slept with Nico, to have fucked him.

Then she said, 'Yes. I did.'

She clasped her hands together in front of her navel, as though she was being told off by the school principal. But Jens smiled so broadly, the bulge in his swim shorts so prominent, she dropped her hands to her side, less fearful.

'Did you enjoy it? Did you... have fun?' he asked her.

'Very much,' she smiled, a little coy again, but looking so delicious as a result.

He leaned into her, breathing in deeply, savoring her scent, and said, uncertain, 'May I...'

She whispered, 'Of course... Whatever you want, sweetie...'

He heard a slight tremor in her voice--nerves, as though this was their first date and they were still in high school. He leaned in, almost touching her, and put his face close to her neck, below her ear. He could smell the sex on her, stronger, as though the hot air was rising from her body up to him. But there was also her smell, her personal sweetness, and the lingering remnants of the new fragrance she'd worn for him. Captivating, it was going to be called.

But he was nervous, too. Frightened, almost, even though he felt such powerful desire for her. He wanted her, but he really didn't know what to do with her. He'd never done anything before. He might look like a complete idiot.

'You want to touch me?' she asked him.

'I... think so,' he said, heart pounding like crazy.

She brought her arms up, gently placing her hands on his shoulders, cautiously checking for any signs that it might freak him out. It felt strangely reassuring to Jens.

'It's okay,' she said. 'You can try whatever you feel up to... and it will all be okay. If you aren't comfortable... just stop.'

'Okay,' he offered her another smile, and she returned it with much more energy. Kind, loving, reassuring.

'You can do whatever you want,' she said quietly, 'and no one will judge you. No one.'

He looked into her eyes. It was as though she could read his mind--she knew what his biggest fears were. He realized that she must have been the same with Nico, after so long without any kind of sexual experience. She understood his anxiety because she'd recently felt the same kind of self-doubt--could she do it, would it make her look foolish, would her shortcomings offend her lover? He looked into her eyes and said, 'I love you.'

'I love you,' she said, barely more than a whisper. 'I always will, no matter what. Now tell me what you want.'

'I want... to touch you.'

'But you're afraid. You're still afraid.'

His eyes fell, a silent admission.

She inched closer to him, her gaze fixed on his face. She said quietly, 'You're embarrassed, aren't you? Because you've never really touched a

woman before. You're afraid... you'll look foolish, because you don't know how to be, you don't know how to act...'

His eyes crept up, meeting hers. Another wordless confirmation that what she was saying was true.

'And because you're so afraid... you would prefer it if another man steps in and does it for you instead...'

'No,' he frowned, suddenly feeling that she had taken a wrong turn in her guesswork concerning his motivations. 'No, that's not quite--'

He didn't want her to think that his fear of humiliation regarding his inability to make love to her was the reason for his desire to see another man do it instead.

She smiled, teasing him. 'I'm sure it's not the whole reason why my infidelity turns you on,' she said, and somehow her saying that explicitly, *my infidelity turns you on* only went and turned him on more.

Her hands dropped, and touched his--gently, cautiously, and then when he didn't flinch, he didn't snatch his away, she held his hands more firmly.

'Don't be afraid,' she said, again almost whispering, her quietness making it all the more intimate--and all the more reassuring. As though she was telling him this was only between them, that the rest of the world didn't know, and wouldn't have to know. Only she would know, and she would not be judging him.

She lifted up his hands, her grip shifting to his wrists so that she could place his palms on her breasts, and then move to press them against her body. His eyes widened as he felt the heat of her body through her swimsuit, as his fingers stretched out and felt the divine shape of her breasts.

'You know, most men would feel humiliated about another man sleeping with their wife,' she said with a naughty smile, gently moving his hands with hers, showing him how to touch her breasts, showing him how to behave. 'You have no problem with me being unfaithful--it makes you happy. More than happy.'

'You deserve--' he tried to say, but she shook her head.

'But you only feel humiliation about... how I might think of you. Because you don't know how to touch me, because you don't know how to make love to me.'

Now she pulled his hands down, guiding them around her, to touch her behind, the swimsuit so racy in style that his fingers came to touch her bare skin, sending tingles and shivers through his body. She was right up against him now, he could feel the heat of her body against his, his

every breath was saturated by her scent, by the smell of sex. The essence of her infidelity.

'You're not really frightened of touching me,' she said, firmly. Making him believe, if he didn't yet. 'Not any more. You know you're not going to get sick by being close to me, by connecting with me.'

He gave a little nod, and her resulting smile was pure brightness, pure beauty.

'You like how I look,' she said, 'You like how I smell...'

Now her hands moved up, past his ears, to the back of his head. She gently coaxed him, guided him to lean in, to do as he wanted. To touch his cheek gently against hers. To slip down so that his mouth and nose grazed against her soft neck. To brush his lips against her skin as he breathed her in. To press his face between her breasts and inhale that taboo scent of her infidelity.

'You like how I fuck other men,' she said, seeming to know how her words would be received, that he would feel fortified against the fear by the arousal from her talking about her wickedness. 'You like it so much,' she continued, 'that if you think about it, you completely forget about your fear of touching me... or me touching you...'

And now he felt her hands delve skillfully into his swim shorts, finding for herself just how hard he was. He breathed, deeply, and thought of how she'd used these very hands to touch another man that same night, to hold his manhood. The thought made his heart pump harder, faster, and pushed away any anxiety he felt because another person was touching him--touching his private parts.

She squeezed him, unexpectedly, and he lifted his head, looked into her sharp, dark eyes.

'You haven't asked me about what happened,' she said. 'Not in any detail, anyway.'

'No.'

She caught her breath, smiled, bit her lip. Intrigued by him. 'You were there. You saw.'

He remained silent, but his manhood bucked in her hands.

She gave a little nod, 'The curtains, they were shut. We never shut the curtains.'

'I didn't have time to get out,' he said.

'But you stayed there, without making a sound.'

It was evidence of his progress, he supposed.

'You watched *everything*.'

He put his hands on her shoulders--bold, for him. 'You were *magnificent*,' he breathed, and slowly dropped to his knees, as though so overwhelmed by her beauty, her desirability, that his legs grew weak. Her hands moved to his head, pressing him to her, his face crushed against her swimsuit, lips and nose pressing against the heat of her body, against her pussy, her adulterous pussy.

'He fucked me so hard,' she said quietly, 'right there, and you enjoyed every minute, honey. Didn't you?'

'I... did,' he said, and realized he'd been holding his breath, afraid of being overwhelmed. Now he let in the air, and his chest was filled with the powerful, dangerous scent of sex. Of his wife's sex with another man.

Effie put her hands on his head, pressing his face gently against her.

'What do you want?'

'I don't know,' he said.

'You're afraid?'

'Afraid... it would be too much for me.'

'We can go slow. Very slow.'

'It's... I didn't mean..'

He wasn't entirely sure what he meant anymore. He was filled with fear and excitement in equal measure.

She said, 'I know you've never done this before. Anything like this.'

'No.'

'You've nothing to be ashamed of. Maybe... you just need me to help you. I can tell you what to do.'

She took a step away from him, toward the edge of the pool. For a moment, he was even worried she'd fall in, but she took only one step back, and then brought one hand slowly up, her fingers brushing over her body and that tight swimsuit, quietly flaunting her figure before him. She slipped a couple of fingers under one of the straps, and eased it off her shoulder. Then off came the other strap, and she peeled the swimsuit down, freeing her gorgeous breasts, her dark, stiff nipples.

'You know,' she said calmly, even though she was risking discovery at any moment--anybody could come out here seeking a late swim and see her like this. 'You know... I can still feel him?'

She smiled, sexy, mischievous. Knowing what she was doing to him. His eyes followed her fingers closely as she continued to slowly peel her swimsuit down, exposing her stomach, her navel, her waist.

'I can feel him all over me,' she said, 'all over my body. Inside and out.'

Now her hands moved to her hips, and she slid the swimsuit down further, revealing her bare pussy, so recently filled by another man. She pushed the swimsuit down over her hips, apparently caring nothing that another resident could walk out and see her naked at any moment.

'The memory of him... fucking me... is still so strong, so intense,' she said, stooping briefly to drop her swimsuit the rest of the way down her trim legs, before straightening again, stepping out of it, completely bare before him.

God, she was the most incredible sight.

She smiled again, sweetly, loving his total attention on her.

'You know what I really want, honey?' she said, 'You inside me instead. Right where he was just now.'

His eyes fell to take in the sight of her adulterous pussy, her freshly fucked pussy.

'I want your big, hard cock where his big, hard cock has just been.'

She took another step back. Now she was right on the edge of the pool--one more move, and she'd be in the water.

'Come get me,' she said with a smirk, turned, and dived gracefully into the pool. He watched her lithe body cut through the water like an arrow. She came up in the middle of the shallow end, and turned to face him, brushing her long, dark, wet hair back over her shoulders, her breasts exposed as she stood with the water level running just below them.

'Come into the water,' she said, 'it's perfect.'

He stood, intrigued, though he wasn't sure quite what she wanted of him. Would he get to touch her? Perhaps she was right, perhaps if it was in the pool, it wouldn't be quite so daunting. The smell of the chlorine was strong, his association of the smell with cleanliness... it might change the rules, somehow.

'You can take those off, for a start,' she giggled, her voice echoing slightly in the large room.

He indicated his swim trunks, his t-shirt, as though there was any question about which she was referring. Surely she couldn't mean... but then she was already naked herself. At first, he felt a sharp pang of fear, of embarrassment. Such a familiar feeling. But he wanted to overcome that feeling. There was also fear of disappointing her, of failing to carry out her request. And right now, with only a small chance of someone interrupting them, that fear seemed to trump the other.

What would someone really think if they came in now? If he was naked, in the pool, with his beautiful wife. A guy would think him lucky.

A woman might, too.

He stripped off his clothes, and Effie giggled in pure delight. Once he felt the air on his exposed body, it felt strange, he felt vulnerable. His cock was hard, for goodness' sake. But the way she looked at him, even from a little distance, added steel to his nerve. He didn't stop for long. Better that the water lend him some cover.

He dived in, keeping his hands firmly together above his head. The cool of the water felt a little startling at first, until he took one stroke, and surfaced a few meters in front of her.

Close up, she was even more stunning. The water droplets clinging to her naked form like tiny gemstones.

'Hi,' she said, beaming from ear to ear.

'Hi,' he said, reflecting her smile.

'You feel okay?'

'Uh-huh.'

She said, 'In here we're both clean, whatever happens. Right?'

His brow wrinkled briefly as he considered what she said. After a moment, he was wondering why they had never thought of this before.

'Yeah,' he said.

Her smile seemed fortified.

He moved closer to her, and she gave a little nod to encourage him, or perhaps to tell him not to stop there. He closed in. Oh God, Oh God. She was divine. He moved so close to her, and then her hands were on his shoulders, and her breasts touched gently against his chest and her cool lips were against his.

She kissed him. Lightly, gently, tenderly. He could smell only the chlorine, but her kiss tasted sweet, somehow. It set his whole body on fire.

It was only brief, but then she looked at him, assessed his response to her kiss, and then kissed him again--longer, deeper, sucking gently on his bottom lip. He took her lead, and imitated her in the kiss, kissing her back in the same way, light and tender, sweetly. She moaned and it set his heart all a-flutter. She wrapped her legs around him in the water, pressing her body to his, crushing his hardness slightly--and it felt electric.

Then she pushed him gently away, breaking apart from him, swimming away a few meters, laughing and giggling. 'That was amazing!' she declared, and he shared her feelings. Even though it was only a kiss, in their marriage it was like climbing a mountain.

He didn't answer, but she read how he was feeling easily enough.

She said, 'Come here.'

He did as she asked, swimming toward her, approaching her. She wrapped her arms around him, and in the water it was okay, he wasn't freaking out.

'I want you inside me,' she said, and then she was kissing him again, so deeply that he had no chance to think about what she'd just demanded, no chance for fear to interrupt.

She was kissing him, and it was just about the best experience he'd ever had, and then he felt her hand deep in the water, her fingers closing around his hard cock, and that felt good, too, and he was so distracted by the warm, thrilling sensations that he could hardly think about what she was doing.

Then he felt something enclosing his manhood, and it wasn't her fingers--couldn't be her fingers. It was so tight, so hot around his tip, around his shaft, but her hands were up on his shoulders now. Her legs wrapped around him again, pulling herself against him, locking her body against his.

Oh God, he was inside her.

She gazed into his eyes, assessing his response, breaking into a smile when she saw he finally realized what was going on, and seemed to like it.

'Oh God, that feels amazing,' she said, in barely more than a whisper.

He felt out of breath, his heart hammering away so hard. He was inside her. His cock was buried deep within her tight pussy. It almost seemed as though he was part of her--he'd never felt closer to her than this.

She moved gently in the water, and his hardness moved slightly inside her. It felt even better, it was like heaven personified.

'You know, you're bigger than he is,' she said, taking him by surprise. 'It feels so good... the best ever...'

His mind flashed back to the sight of her wrapped around another man, her pussy filled by another cock--and suddenly, Jens felt a trigger fired deep within his loins, and a wave of pure unbridled pleasure burst from between his legs, and his cock was jolting, pulsing, bucking inside her.

She giggled, and as he gazed in her pretty face as though to find out what was happening, he realized he was shooting his come into her, deep inside her. He wrinkled up his face, suddenly grossed out and horrified that she should have to experience such a thing--but she grabbed him,

squeezed him, and moaned as though nothing had ever been so wonderful.

'Oh honey...' she breathed, and her smile was just about the most beautiful thing he'd ever seen. 'You came inside me... it feels so good...'

She kissed him again as his cock fired off the last few spurts inside her, and his revulsion melted away. It did feel good, it felt incredible, but what felt best was how happy she seemed to be, how much pleasure it seemed to give her.

'Can you believe it?' she giggled, staring into his eyes. 'We're *so* good together.'

FRESH PASTURES

'Well I must say, I'm impressed,' the therapist said.

'Thank you,' Jens said, but a mite puzzled at being complimented for the rather personal details of his sexual awakening with his wife.

'Not many people, faced with the kind of issues you are facing, could make the kind of progress you have achieved.'

'I was lucky, I suppose.'

The therapist nodded, and gave a rare warm smile. 'I'd almost be tempted to jot something down for an academic journal, except that it seems to me your own personal journey is not likely to be one repeated by others.'

'No.'

'Well, at least by others with your condition. You have a somewhat unique strategy for defeating your anxieties, Mr Nielsen. Your obsessive thoughts, your compulsions.'

'It's been the support of my wife...'

'Yes. I'll say. So what happens next in your story?'

Jens sighed. He glanced at his watch. 'Effie's dating somebody new.'

'Oh, she is?'

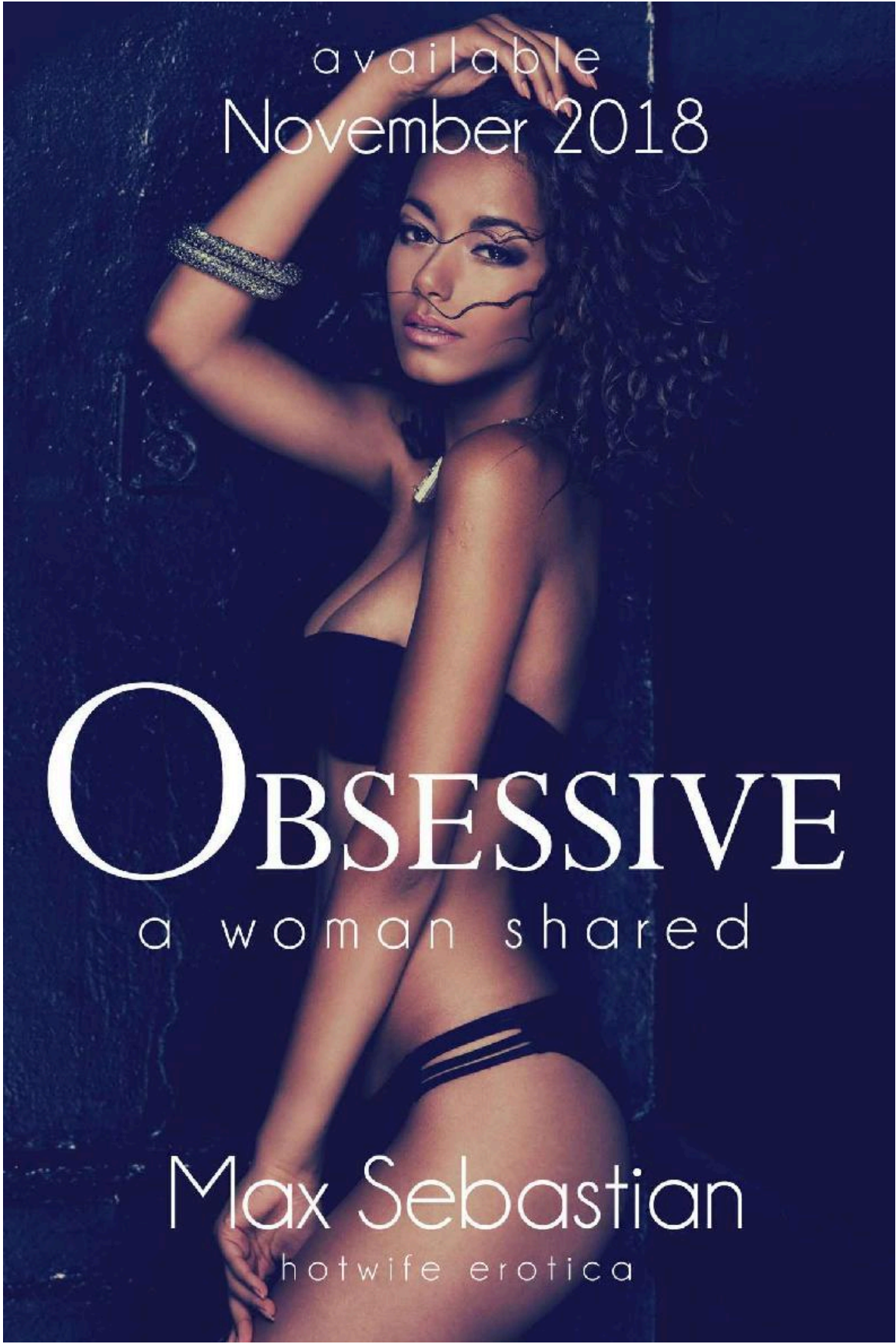
He shrugged. 'Nicolai... he's a consultant, and he's no longer working with her company. He works in different places -- he's just been posted to assist a company in Aarhus for six months. Effie decided they should break it off for now.'

'So she's seeing somebody new, now?'

Jens nodded. He didn't look entirely happy, the therapist noted.

'What is it?' the man asked him.

'Tonight,' Jens said, 'Effie wants me to meet him. This time her date knows all about us, all about me. Effie wants me to be there, right with them, when he makes love to her.'



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OBSESSIVE

a woman shared

Max Sebastian
hotwife erotica

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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And of course, thanks to you the reader, for supporting this work through your patronage.

More to come, very soon.

Max Sebastian, *London, October 2018*

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Max Sebastian is the Amazon-bestselling author of *The Madeleine Trilogy*, *What's Mine is Yours* and *Rock Her World*.

He specializes in sizzling hot, romantic erotic stories that challenge the conventional boundaries of modern relationships, featuring naughty wives and insatiable girlfriends, along with the husbands or boyfriends who adore them.

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